

DEEP THOUGHTS NOVELS

BATTLE — OF THE — BRETHREN



OPEYEMI AKINTUNDE

As Inspired by the CREATIVE ONE)

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(AS INSPIRED BY THE LIVING WORD)

DEEP THOUGHTS NOVEL

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BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN

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APPRECIATION

I APPRECIATE THE ALMIGHTY GOD FOR THE PRIVILEGE GIVEN TO WRITE MASTERPIECE... ALL GLORY TO GOD...

I THIS APPRECIATE MY WONDERFUL HUSBAND, AKINWALE AKINTUNDE, YOU MAKE MARRIAGE LOOK AND FEEL SO SIMPLE, YOUR UNFLINCHING SUPPORT TOWARDS MY MINISTRY EVEN BAFFLES ME... IT MAKES ME KNOW THAT GOD'S EYES ARE ALL OVER ME... THANK YOU FOR BEING MY FRIEND, MY TEACHER, MY MOTIVATOR, MY LOVER...AND EVERYTHING YOU HAVE IN YOUR CAPACITY TO BE TO ME...

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TO YOU, MY READERS & SOCIAL MEDIA FOLLOWERS. IF I HAD NO ONE TO READ, THERE WON'T HAVE BEEN THE NEED TO WRITE... THANKS FOR ALWAYS READING. GOD BLESS YOU...MY PRAYER FOR YOU IS THAT AS YOU GO THROUGH THIS BOOK, YOU WILL FIND GOD ON THE PAGES OF THIS BOOK IN JESUS NAME

DEDICATION

I DEDICATE THIS NOVEL TO MY SOURCE, MY INSPIRATION BANK,
MY FOUNDATION, THE GIVER OF THE OIL UPON MY HEAD... TO GOD
THE FATHER, THE SON AND THE HOLY SPIRIT. I AM NOTHING
WITHOUT THE TRINITY

CHAPTER 1
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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When She Walked In...

You know that feeling when PHCN (Power Company) brings light after two straight days of darkness? That shift in the air, the brightness...that's how it felt the first Sunday she showed up.

I was at the media desk, asking Bro Jude; Head of Media why the projector was not coming up. My Name is Mabel: Mummy G.O's P.A... I am many things to Mama... Her Gist Patner... Her Outfit checker...Her Spy... Her Ears , Mouth and Eyes. She had signaled to me to go check why the Projector wasn't working. She didn't have to speak, I understood every of her move. Apart from this, I am also a member of the Choir, and any group Mummy G.O wanted me to be... You get Right? I am sure you do.

Well, don't get this twisted, this story isn't about me, it's about the girl who walked in.

Bro Jude was struggling with the projector remote (battery acting stubborn), when the left side door opened. Tall, slim, simple Ankara gown, face bare...no heavy makeup, yet something glowed. She didn't strut; she kind of glided, like she knew where every pew leg was before her feet landed.

Nobody announced her. No "first-timers please rise." Still, heads turned as if a silent bell tolled.

Daddy G.O. was halfway through a story...how he missed a flight because the Holy Spirit said “wait.” Mid-sentence, he paused, eyes flicked to the left. Only two seconds, but I caught it. My job is noticing things.

Ushers offered her a middle-row seat. She smiled that quiet “thanks” smile and sat. End of story, right? Except when prayer moved to tongues, *wahala* (trouble) started.

Most people did the usual mutter-mutter. But this new lady’s voice...low but steady...rose like a cello in the background. Not loud, just deep, bass like a male’s voice, a voice that must have mastered the art of prayer so much, it had deepened. I felt goosebumps creep under my jacket. The brother beside her opened one eye, glanced, then shut it fast, as if looking at her might blind him.

Service closed. I intentionally carried visitor’s slips and went straight to her (Remember Mama would want to know the *deets* about her). She filled hers quick: TIJESUNI ADEYEMI (T.J.). Address: No. 14, Peace Bello Avenue. Phone. 0811234.... Occupation: Creative Designer. I wanted to ask “Graphic or fashion?” but more people were calling me, so I pocketed the question. Something I noticed when I was with her... there was an atmosphere of prayer around her, you had the urge to speak in tongues, or find a quiet place and talk to your creator.

I quickly excused myself as I had to get back to Mama.

By the stairs that leads to Mama’s Office, choir leader Edna cornered me.

“Mabel, who’s that new chick?”

Her tone was light; her eyes were not.

I shrugged. “First timer. Cool vibes.”

Edna nodded, but her lips pressed thin like she’d bitten unripe mango. That was my first alert. Edna was the Choir Leader, one of the ancient members of the church, You know those who were born and raised in the church, those who could give you a lecture about how the church came into existence, those who will tell you how they carried the blocks used in building the mighty edifice on their heads when they were kids. You sabi them abi? (You know them right?)

Meanwhile, T.J. lingered, greeting random teens, helping a grandma. Every handshake looked like electricity jumping terminals. Folks smiled wider after touching her, and I am sure they couldn’t even explain why.

On my way to Mama’s office, I overheard two ushers whisper:

“See how atmosphere change...the girl carry something.”

“Abi o! Hope she humble sha... choir people fit beef her.”

I chuckled. Beef already marinating. Everyone knew that the Choir-stand was the unofficial administrative headquarters. They legit decide the fate of members, Pastors, workers...everyone. Once beef starts from the choir-stand against you, Know that you are on your way out of the church-*Shamefully*.

Inside the admin block, Mama asked, “Who’s that lady?”

I gave a short brief. Mama nodded, reached for her handbag, then sighed; the kind that means watch that space.

Later that evening, while locking Mama’s office door, I thought of her again. No thunder, no scripture-quoting, but my spirit kept replaying her calm, bass-rich prayer. Something told me this guest wasn’t just passing through.

In other words, dear reader, drama had stepped into the building wearing sky-blue Ankara.

And trust me, our church was not ready.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 2
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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Smoke in the Choir Loft

It didn't take long.

By the next Wednesday...midweek service..her name had already entered group chats. Not church announcements o, WhatsApp ones. You know those coded groups that have titles like “Choir Flow ” or “Pastor’s Media Soldiers”?

Yeah. Those ones.

People were asking questions, dropping soft jabs masked as banter.

“That new girl sabi pray o. You hear her that Sunday?”

“Na only prayer she sabi? Let her wait small before showing herself.”

“Hope she’ll be committed... this our church no be where you shine and run.”

I acted like I didn’t see it, but I did. I always do .Mama ensured I was in all the group chats, and I always had an insider in the groups who will add my unknown phone number. My best Ally was Sharon. Sharon was everyone’s friend and gist partner(Let’s be our brother’s keeper by not using the real term- Gossip, so let’s help her ministry by calling her everyone’s gist partner). You get it? I am sure you do.

By Thursday, her picture was flying around. Someone had screen-grabbed a clip from our livestream...T.J., eyes closed, lips barely moving, right hand raised mid-prayer. The light in the photo? Too clean. Her head scarf? Sitting like an angel picked it out. People were re-posting it with captions like:

“Now this is how to carry fire and still look like a daughter of Zion.”

“Fire wey get sauce”

It even went beyond WhatsApp groups, it found its way to main social media and beneath such posts, I started reading comments like..

“ Address of Church Please!”

“ She looks like she is seeing the face of an angel”

“ This one no come church con look for brother, She came to see Jesus!”

“ Sis didn’t come to play, she came to pray”

“ In the same Church, you will still see children of Satan ooo”

“ Wife Material..1 billion yards”

Me I just smiled while reading the comments, at least it felt good that our Church was in the blogs without having to pay them. But deep in choir corner, storm clouds were gathering.

Rehearsal that Saturday was tense. This was two Saturdays after she joined the church. I am not much of a singer, but I am in the choir, so I hear things; half gists, full gists, and gists that people think they're hiding.

Sister Edna stood in her usual spot, head high, heels sharp, voice sharper. Who wears heels to Saturday rehearsals if not someone who wants to prove dominance.

“Let's run that ‘My Altar is Calling’ again. Sopranos, come up or come out!” She said in her full commander mode.

But there was more to today's rehearsal. She kept glancing sideways...to where T.J. was sitting quietly at the back, observing the rehearsal like she didn't notice the chilly air being pumped in her direction.

The girl had quietly joined choir. Nobody forced her. During the “join-a-department” drive the previous Sunday, she signed up. Even I was surprised. I thought she'd pick evangelism or intercessory. But no, she said “I want to join the choir” with a soft smile.

Edna told her she had to sit out some rehearsals to observe how things were being done. Immediately Rehearsal was over, T.J picked her bag and left.

I wanted to rush towards her when Edna held my hand...

“Mabel... her type. Always humble at first, let her sit for 20 rehearsals.. we will know her motive”

“20 rehearsals!” I wanted to scream...Five Months, Choir Probation after you must have been auditioned is 2 months(8 rehearsals) and even at that, you would have started joining the rehearsals from the 2nd week. ...She had not even heard her voice to know if she could sing.

Instead, I didn't respond....

I knew who to speak with... Brother Solomon. The only person Edna could drop everything for. The most eligible Bachelor in our Church, Soft Spoken, Calm, fresh looking, Sharp looking, Money Speaking, handsome but God Loving brother of the Most High God.

You know those brothers that have it all.. Pink lips, Fair skinned with rich dark beards, His Outfit was always well ironed, he served the lord with all of his heart as an Usher. He is the Kind of Usher you want to Usher you to your seat and eventually to the altar where you will say “ I do” and the congregation will say “ God When”

Edna had been hoping and Praying that some day Brother Solomon would just hint that he liked her, because Brother Solomon didn't follow the path of his Biblical namesake. He was very disciplined with ladies. He avoided any form of ‘ situationship’, so if he asked Edna for one thing she would give him a 100 things.

By next Saturday, I saw that T.J had joined the rehearsal, I smiled. The power of Brother Solomon....and of course Me.. Mabel.

On Sunday morning, the real drama began.

You see, during service, when the choir started singing softly during prayer...T.J.'s voice somehow floated in from the back. Nobody gave her a mic, but you could hear her low harmony melting into the lead. It was beautiful. She wasn't trying to prove anything or be seen, She was just singing from a place of worship that was so tangible.

Even Daddy G.O. paused during the altar call and said, "Hmm. Someone's worship is reaching heaven this morning." How her voice was so distinct in the large choir was a course to be studied.

Boom.

People turned.

Heads craned.

T.J. didn't even lift her head. It felt like she was lost in worship. Her eyes were tightly shut.

But Edna? Her face showed the state of her heart. She adjusted her scarf. And I kid you not, she changed the next worship song on the fly...something sharper, something more technical. As if to say, Let's see if you can follow this one, girl!

She announced it like this:

“Let's go higher and deeper in his presence...key of D, tempo 3. Watch my cue.”

Translation: This is not your random “I'm-spiritual” singalong. This is training-ground music.

T.J. didn't try to follow. She just stayed in her seat at the choir stand, singing along like any regular member. But even in that, there was grace. There was stillness. The kind that makes noise sound like noise.

By closing prayer, I could feel smoke in the air...not real smoke, but the kind that starts rising when flesh starts heating up. And trust me, I've worked at this church long enough to know when something is burning in people's hearts.

On my way to return Mama's handbag, I saw what should not have happened, in fact what has never happened before...Brother Solomon walked up to T.J. outside and said hi. She nodded politely, didn't linger, and walked off.

A minute later, I saw Edna staring from a distance. Arms folded. Her face a painting of several emotions.

I whispered in my mind: Uh oh. Cain is sharpening his sword. Wahala be like what? Wahala be like when Cain noticed God appreciated Abel's offering more than his, and because of that, he became angry.. Edna could see that Brother Solomon seemed fascinated by T.J. It was about to get hot in church, and I was so sure all the Air conditioners in the building would not be able to cool off that heat.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 3
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Murmurs After Midnight

You see ehn, some things don't happen in broad daylight.

They happen after midweek service, when everybody has gone home, church is quiet, and WhatsApp starts to buzz.

That night, I was in Mama's parlour, helping her pick fabric for the upcoming women's conference. She had brought out four different lace materials, asking which one screamed "not-your-regular-Mummy-G.O." I was just about to vote for the royal blue one when her phone buzzed.

She glanced. Then she paused.

"Mabel... Is the new girl a concern to the Choir Leaders?"

I blinked. "I have not heard anything"

“Then why are they discussing her on the Choir Leaders’ forum?”

Wahala.!

She turned the phone so I could see. And there it was...one of those late-night hot takes that’s always coded like prayer concern.

“Let’s continue to pray for new members... some people carry presence, but not all presence is pure.”

Another replied with a clapping emoji.

Another said:

“Very true. We don’t know where she’s coming from or who sent her.”

And then..a ridiculous one that made me almost hiss out loud:

“Jezebel also looked spiritual.”

“How?” I thought within. “When they would not read their Bibles. Where is it written in the Bible that Jezebel Looked spiritual or modest?” I continued my thought.

People don't waste time o. One minute you're seen as a revivalist, next minute they're calling you Bible witch.

Mama didn't say anything else, but I saw how her lips tightened. She typed something and dropped the Phone..

As for me, I carried the material and folded it. My mind was no longer on colour. That chat had confirmed something:

T.J. had entered their skin. Deep.

By Friday, even the church cleaning aunties were whispering.

“That girl... you see the way Pastor Okey and even Brother Solomon dey greet am last Sunday?”

“Me I no talk o... but I hope she no come scatter things.”

“Na so e dey start.” (That's how it always begins.)

By Saturday, During rehearsal Edna started strategizing. I didn't need to see her planner...I could smell it from her attitude.

During soundcheck, she “mistakenly” told the sound team not to give mic to any new chorister who hasn't been “cleared spiritually.” She used those words...“cleared spiritually” ...like it was immigration checkpoint.

One of the backup singers asked quietly, “You mean T.J.?”

Edna just smiled and walked away.

But her eyes? Her eyes were doing the work.

That night, one of the younger sisters sent me a voice note.

“Aunty Mabel, please ma, don’t tell anybody I sent this o. But they said Sis T.J. is making Pastor Dan act somehow. He now comes early to choir rehearsal just to sit near her. Even Brother Solomon can no longer concentrate in service, They said Sis T.J is possessed with the Seducing Spirit, Is it True?”

I played the voice note twice.

Ah. Pastor Dan...Edna’s second Choice. Edna lived like the world revolved around her, you know it has always been preached that marriage is an institution of learning, So just like you would have your First and second choice when pursuing your university admission, Edna had a first and second choice for marriage... I laughed in Spanish, because this Sister T.J had come to shake the very table Edna had comfortably sat on for years. A table she never shared with anyone. Though people secretly admired Pastor Dan and Brother Solomon, no one dared mentioned it even to their best friends...It was all in their eyes and heart.

But here were the two men seeking the attention of the new girl. T.J was looking like a ministerial threat and an emotional threat to Choir Leader Edna.

I didn't need a vision to know: fire had entered the bush.

Wahala be like what again?

Wahala be like when Cain dey prepare hin offering and dey use side-eye watch Abel. (Trouble is when a person pretends to be spiritual while boiling with jealousy on the inside.)

But on a second thought, I screamed

“ Grace!”

Grace be like what again?

“Grace be like when the good thing wey others dey chase, con dey chase you” (Grace is when the good things others are running after start running after you.)

“ This girl called T.J is Graced!” I said to myself or is it something else?

I closed my phone and lay on my bed that night. My heart was turning small small. I knew too much. A lot of information I was privy to. I came to a conclusion before sleeping off

Church supposed be hospital for broken people, But sometimes... na the nurses dey carry the infection pass. (The Church is meant to be a hospital

for the broken, but sometimes.. it's the caretakers that spread the infection more)

What are your thoughts?

To be continued...

CHAPTER 4
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Offerings and Side-Eyes

5 weeks Later

You know how there are some Sundays you don't forget?

That Sunday? Legendary.

It was Testimony & Thanksgiving service—the kind that comes with matching Ankara, dancing with baskets of yam, and that one uncle who always forces his way to the mic to shout “He who has done it again will do it again again again!”

T.J. came to church in a clean lilac gown, scarf tied low, no makeup as usual, but she had this fresh-face kind of glow..like she slept inside Psalm 23.

Me I was just arranging Mama's fan and handkerchief when Daddy G.O climbed the altar for the word of encouragement before offering. But the thing he said next?

Na there the fire started to spread.

“Some of us gave our offerings from our bank accounts... but one person gave his or hers from her soul.”

Daddy G.O paused, holding up a white sheet of paper.

“The writer didn’t put a name. But the accounting department brought this to me just now. Alongside his or her financial offering, he or she added a thanksgiving love letter to God... on behalf of all of us.”

He glanced at the paper again, his voice softening.

I give you my all, Lord. I am thanking you for this church. Thank You for Daddy G.O and Mummy G.O. Thank You... Thank You for the families in church.”

He looked up.

“You see... that’s an offering God cannot ignore.”

Gbam.

The room went silent . The keyboardist even froze. Then a slow clap started from the right. Everyone looked around.

And you know church people...they always know who you're talking about.

Two rows in front of me, I saw Edna's shoulder jerk. She turned her face, but the tightness in her lips said everything.

T.J. sat still. No smiling. No blushing. Just... peace. That girl sabi mind her business sha. And that's what made it worse.

If she had stood up to bask in the glory or acted too holy-holy, maybe people would brush it off. But no. She just sat there like "This kind of attention wasn't in my plan."

Which made people love her more.

Which made Edna more annoyed.

After the service, I was walking past the youth canopy when I caught part of a conversation.

"Abeg abeg, what kind of seed is that?"

"Is it not drama to be writing such deep things inside offering envelope?"

"This generation and attention seeking..."

I knew that voice.

Edna.

She wasn't loud. But she didn't need to be. She had mastered the art of "Holy Shade."

I passed quietly, pretending not to hear, but I knew what she was doing.

T.J. had entered the spiritual spotlight, and it was not on Edna's schedule.

By evening, a new nickname was trending among the choir group:

"Seed Writer."

As in, "Don't come and be writing seed like that new sister o. We too can write touching things inside our envelopes."

They laughed, but it wasn't funny.

That must have been how Cain started...with jokes.

With comparison....With God favoring someone's offering more than yours.

And the only thing Cain could think of was not to do better...

But to make the other person disappear.

Wahala.

Mama called me to her room around 8pm.

“Who wrote that offering line?”

I told her quietly.

She nodded. Slowly.

Then after a pause, she said:

“She’s stirring spirits.”

I replied, “Good or bad?”

Mama didn’t answer.

She just said, “Watch. People like that never go unnoticed in church. Heaven notices. Hell notices. Humans? They hate what they can’t explain..and that hate if not handled quickly, can turn deadly. They either

silence it physically or Spiritually. The Pharisees and the Sadducees did not understand Jesus, so they sought to kill him... People Kill what they don't understand"

She was right.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 5
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The Mentor Trap

It's Mabel here, still your gist plug, still collecting holy whispers from all corners.

There are different types of pastors in every big church.

There's Daddy G.O. — the lion.

There's Mummy G.O. — the eagle.

Then there's Pastor Dan — the chameleon.

Handsome. Calm voice. Always smiling like Jesus just told him a joke. As a Music Pastor, all the female Choristers get distracted every Sunday. The kind of man that can greet you and your body temperature will rise spiritually o, of course. He is Edna's Second Choice.

He wasn't married. That fact alone made him the subject of 80% of our sisters' prayer requests. Yet, somehow, he had managed to dodge relationship drama for years. Always saying:

“God hasn’t released me into that covenant yet.” Church people and deep sayings to cover up...

But the moment T.J. arrived...

His spirit became very... released.

Like the teen said in her voice note, It started subtle...

He began sitting close to the choir during service. As Music pastor, he mostly sat with other pastors at the Minister’s Stand, but Since T.J came , ‘Baba’ (Pastor Dan) felt he should be closer to his Choristers. I laugh in Ijebu Language.

He Started attending rehearsals very early because T.J comes 30 minutes earlier.

Started asking Sharon about T.J.’s background....random questions like:

“Where did she grow up?”

“Is she in a relationship?”

“What does she do, exactly?”

And unlike Sharon, she didn’t have answers because T.J didn’t give any. Sharon tried to get friendly, but T.J ensured to keep it simple and courteous. Even Sharon slipped one day when she said “ this lady is not your regular Christian Sister, She has walls around her, I have not been able to get her spill a thing about herself or even talk about others.”

Then, one Sunday after service, Pastor Dan approached her by himself near the gate.

I saw it because I was collecting Mama's extra wrapper from the car. He leaned slightly forward...not too close to be suspicious, but close enough to say, "We're having a private moment." to anyone who wanted to interfere. As expected all eyes were on them.

"Sister Tijesuni... the Lord impressed it on my heart to guide you." he said proudly. Other ladies would lose their home training if they heard pastor Dan say that to them.

She smiled. "Guide me, sir?"

"Yes. You carry something rare, and the weight of such grace must be balanced with structured mentorship. You're a gift to this altar. Your voice needs a form of discipleship so it can travel far."

"Sorry ooo Mentor Extraordinaire! Mr tour Guide! Did she say she needed a guide" I laughed. I had stayed glued to Mama's car, where I stayed to hear the conversation.. See how it is Mentor that is begging someone to be his mentee...Laugh will not kee pesin! What will man not see on this surface called earth and in this plane called Church!

Wahala !

Wahala be like what again?

Wahala be like mentor wey dey use mentorship and discipleship chase babe.

(Wahala is like a mentor using mentorship and discipleship to chase a woman.)

But Grace be like what?

Grace be like when honour find you without you lobbying for it.

(Grace is when honour locates you without you begging or struggling for it.)

When you carry something, something comes looking for you, When you carry nothing, Nothing will come looking for you... Well! back to our story, What do you think My Sister T.J did to him, she served him hot tea respectfully...

She nodded slowly, thanked him, and walked away.

But looking at Pastor Dan, it looked like he was fine with it... it looked like he knew what he was doing... It felt like he just planted a seed...Nothing dramatic.

A Little seed because as I watched him watching her walk off, I knew: he wasn't guiding her into growth. He was guiding her into a corner.

To be continued....

CHAPTER 6
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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Two days later before Tuesday Bible Study, Edna was in Mama's office discussing "departmental alignment." Somehow, the topic swerved to T.J.

"Mama, we thank God for new people. But leadership should be careful about who lays hands on the people."

Mama blinked. "Who's laying hands?"

"I'm just saying... the new Sister looks like someone who may want to do that...Mama, when fire burns too bright too fast, it can become wildfire."

I knew where that line came from. Pastor Dan used it before...on another girl he was "mentoring" two years ago. She left church after a 'talk' with Mama. Till today, nobody knows what happened. But I remember seeing her cry in the toilet after that talk.

The playbook was familiar.

By Thursday, Pastor Dan started texting her quotes.

I didn't hack her phone...I'm not that kind of PA. But people forward things. Screenshots fly. Sharon knew how to get into people's phones and screenshot their conversations. I am pretty sure Pastor Dan must have been charging his phone in the Choir office and Sharon with her ways must have been at the right place at the right time.

One of the texts read:

"Your spirit reminds me of Deborah; bold, powerful, but still needing the guidance of a Barak."

God Abeg! I screamed in my room. See Holy rizz!

Another read:

"Let me be the umbrella that keeps your fire from burning out too soon."

Umbrella? Would the fire not burn the Umbrella?

I laughed so hard, I dropped my phone.

But something wasn't connecting, If Pastor Dan was after T.J, why was Edna using Pastor Dan's quote.

T.J. didn't reply much. Everyone noticed her choice of words in her responses. The Screenshot showed it. She would casually put the "Thank You" Emoji or "Prayer" Emoji or "Angel" Emoji. She stayed on her lane.

Still came for prayer meetings. Still sang quietly from the back at the Choir stand.

But the tension was rising. Brother Solomon was closing in. Pastor Dan was closing in. It was beginning to look like a love triangle between T.J, and the two most eligible Bachelors in Church. Also T.J's voice was beginning to attract attention. Edna was the best singer before T.J joined and it seem the baton was about to be taken from her and given to the new girl on the block.

Edna could sense it. The spotlight was about to be put on someone else other than her.

The same man- Pastor Dan- who once said "You're the most spiritually disciplined woman I've ever met"... was now rotating his compass.

And jealousy doesn't like second place.

That night, I sat in the church alone. I had a sudden burden to pray for T.J. There was a witness in my Spirit that the girl didn't come in to compete, she only came to compliment.

To confirm my conviction, Grandma Kosoko...One of the earliest Grandmas whispered in my ears when I went to greet her after that evening service...

"This Church has been dark for some years.. I prayed... I prayed.. light came in but was short lived. I didn't give up.. I kept praying...and it seems Light has stepped in wearing Ankara and Canvas, I hope they don't kill the light like they did with Sunmbo" She had said

I looked at her and she nodded looking towards T.J as she had once again been cornered by Pastor Dan. She was wearing Ankara and canvas.

Sunmbo!

Grandma Just reminded me of her! The girl who had come two years earlier. She was in the Intercessory department, before we knew it, she and the teenagers were holding two hours prayers every Sunday after service.. In one month, we were beginning to see changes in the teens department. The teens were no longer restless. The “ who is dating who” gist had taken the back bench in discussions, it was more of “Fire, Purpose and Rhema conversations” that became the main topics.

What Changed?

Pastor Dan came into the picture!

Same playbook he is trying to use on T.J... was what he used on Sunmbo...

Mentor! Rhema Discussing partners! And somehow I think (Not confirmed) they shared more, because she started looking at him softly while he became more dominant in their conversations.

He joined her in praying with the teenagers...He wasn't invited.. He just invited himself and took over.

Yes! He took over! Telling Sunmbo she needed mentorship so as not to lead the teenagers astray. He told her... she had the zeal but not the training.

He was with Mama one Sunday after service... I had eavesdropped on the last part of the conversation...

“ Mama, When fire burns too bright too fast, it can become wildfire.” he had said to Mama.

This was the exact statement I heard Edna quote to Mama earlier that week.. I didn't need a prophet to tell me..there was something shady happening already.

Because it was shortly after he said that Statement, that Mama sent for Sunmbo. I was not in the office when Sunmbo came around. The next thing I saw was her crying. I tried asking her the obvious question, but she wasn't having it, She looked at me like she had been betrayed. She stormed out of the church and never came back!

And the interesting part!

No one dared reach out to her because news got out that Mama spoke with her!

Who dares speaks after Mummy G.O has spoken ! No one.

All of this flashed before me as I sat in the church and all I could whisper in prayer was...

“Lord... if this is a battle, let her wear the right armour.”

Because in Holy & Fire Altar Assembly...

Battles don't always start on the altar.

They start in the heart and only the strong at heart wins.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 7
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Mic Off, Heart On..

It's me Mabel Again. No sugarcoating. Just the gist, raw and real.

They finally gave her a mic.

After almost eight weeks of watching from the sidelines, blending in, and minding her heaven-bound business, T.J. was asked to “just take the worship for five minutes” during Thursday night choir rehearsal.

I won't lie...I was shocked.

Not because she wasn't good.

But because the approval came through Edna.

Yes, Sister Edna herself.

The same Edna who had been dodging her during harmonies.

The same Edna who, just a few days ago, made a snide comment about “mic hygiene” and how new people should serve for at least four months before touching technical equipment.

So when she turned to T.J. and said,

“You can take worship today. Let’s hear what the Lord has deposited in you,”

Everybody froze.

That “let’s hear” sounded sweet, but my spirit screamed setup.

T.J. didn’t hesitate. She smiled, collected the mic with two hands in respect like it was communion bread, and quietly said:

“Let’s rise and just whisper thanks to God. We don’t need to shout. Just whisper...”

The choir stood. Some sluggishly. Others suspiciously.

And then she began.

A soft hum.

No lyrics at first. Just this mellow, sweet wave of sound like you were inside a cloud.

Within 60 seconds!!! Atmosphere: shifted. Voices: trembling. Hearts: melting.

Fire everywhere.... It happened so far. She literally threw all of us in the atmosphere.

Even I .. a whole Mabel, seasoned assistant of the pulpit's pulpit...felt tears pressing at the back of my eyes.

That voice wasn't just music. That hum wasn't just humming. It was communication to the father to invite him into our midst in a flash. It was like she dialed Heaven on speed dial.

It was oil.

Then the mic crackled.

First time. T.J. paused, smiled. Continued.

Then it cut out completely.

Dead.

She tapped it once, twice. Looked to the sound booth.

Brother Chinedu...the sound guy...was sweating. Literally.

He did the “I’m fixing it” hand wave, but nothing changed.

T.J. didn’t panic. She just stepped away from the mic, raised her voice a little, and continued leading... without the mic.

And guess what?

She got louder.

Not physically. Spiritually.

The Spirit of God moved!

Even without sound, her voice rang like thunder inside people’s bones. Almost everyone dropped to their knees shuddering. Some sobbed in Worship of Five minutes. The choir forgot the harmony. They just followed.

Me? I was already on one knee, whispering:

“ God! Don’t let me miss what you have for us through this girl”

It was obvious God was resident in her life. It was evident God wanted to say a thing or two through her to our church. It was Obvious God wanted us to see how we youths and the General Church should burn for him. Our church had lost her fire. We were just flourishing on old glory.

The teens choir were also having their rehearsal. They didn't need to be invited to join us. The Presence drew them in. I looked back when I heard footsteps.. I saw them filing in and joining the Worship...

Edna's legs were somehow glued to the ground. I could see the confusion on her face. I could read the conflict as to whether she should stop the worship or allow herself to be a part of it.

I believe the Lord kept her glued to the same spot till T.J ended the worship after 10 minutes.

After the session, Edna clapped.

One of those slow, tight claps with a straight face.

"Powerful," she said. "Let's make sure next time, your mic is checked before rehearsal."

Ah.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like when dem give Abel mic, and Cain go hide the battery.

(Trouble is when someone shines, and another person tries to dim the light by pulling out the power source.)

T.J. didn't react the way any human would have. She innocently just said, "Yes ma," and went to sit down.

But something changed that day.

A few choir members started calling her “Worship Plug.”

One even whispered, “That girl no need mic. She be the mic.”

Ayaaa!

And that was the beginning of the crack inside the choir wall.

Later that night, I got a voice note from Chinedu...the sound guy.

“Sister Mabel, I swear I charged that mic before rehearsal. Battery was full. But once she touched it, the thing blacked out like PHCN was angry.”

I didn’t reply.

What could I say?

Some power outages are not technical.

They’re sabotages born out of envy.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 8
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Screenshots and Sub-tweets.

In this generation, even church battles share in your data subscription. You pay for sub to read gist about who is dating who? Who is fighting who? Who is facing the disciplinary committee? And so on....

Well... This particular clip didn't drain data, because it was short.

The clip didn't even last one minute.

Just 47 seconds.

But by 10 a.m. the next morning, it had made its way to all the youth department WhatsApp groups, our media team's Telegram thread, and one anonymous Instagram account that I suspect is run by a certain keyboardist's ex-girlfriend. Someone in the choir recorded that moment...

T.J., eyes closed.

No mic.

Still singing.

The Still yet vibrating atmosphere like she owned the rights to oxygen.

And the caption? Whew.

“Some carry presence. Others carry protocol. Choose your fighter.”

See Shade! They have picked fighters...T.J...the one with the Presence and Edna with the protocol.

Omo! Oh my Father who art in Heaven! Forgive your children on earth!

Before I could even sip tea that morning, my phone was buzzing. People forwarding, reacting, arguing.

Two camps had formed.

Camp 1 Were the “God-is-raising-her” gang.

These ones were dropping comments like:

“We need this kind of fire abeg.”

“Shey you see why we need new wine? Old wine dey turn belle. Too much deadness in Choir-stand.”

“Grace is not age-based. Leave her alone.”

Camp 2 were the “***But-she’s-new-now***” ***squad***.

Their comments had a holy-but-hot tone:

“Is she the only one in choir?”

“Clout-chasing in church is now looking spiritual o.”

“Let’s watch and see. Consistency reveals character.”

And me? I just sat and watched everything unfold like soap opera .

Because I knew who posted the video.

Her name won’t be mentioned (my mouth no dey run), but let’s just say she holds soprano line three, has acrylic nails that glow in the dark, and has posted “#NoFilter #JesusGirl” more times than she’s posted actual scriptures. Maybe you will meet her in later chapters...

She wasn’t trying to celebrate T.J.

She was trying to spotlight the division.

And it worked.

That Saturday during choir meeting, Edna didn't raise the video.

But she didn't have to.

Her topic was "The Danger of Performance Spirit in the House of God."

Her eyes moved around the room like torchlight, then rested...briefly...on T.J.

"Some of us don't even know we're being used by the enemy. It starts with innocent singing. Then comes platform-seeking. Before long, you've become the devil's karaoke."

Everyone chuckled nervously.

T.J.?

No blink.

No flinch.

Just that same steady peace like she had plugged her heart into the Holy Ghost and thrown away the switch. It seem like you couldn't turn her off.

That silence was driving people madder than a shout ever could.

Later that evening, one of the assistant choir coordinators pulled me aside.

“Mabel, she needs to slow down.”

I asked, “She do anything wrong?”

She hesitated.

“No... but she’s everywhere.”

I smiled and said, “Abi she’s just visible because God decided to shine his spotlight on her?...Any one who is offended by her visibility should go and pray for their own visibility instead of turning themselves to familiar and monitoring agent. Right?”

She no answer me again. (She couldn’t answer)

On Sunday morning, the person in charge of media slides made a little change.

During worship, when they usually display “Worship led by: Holy & Fire Choir”, they added:

“Featuring: Sister Tijesuni A.”

Small thing.

But na small spark dey burn estate.(A small spark can burn an estate down)

But seriously, who added that featuring... There are people who are the ones who makes the anointed to become the subject of hatred. I could tell that Bro Jude too was already been smitten by T.J because tell me why that Featuring was necessary, and tell me why T.J appears on the screen like 10 times in one service.

I believe Bro Jude must have given the Camera guys instructions to always capture T.J during services and he would leave it too long on screen.

In fact she was beginning to have more screen time than Mama herself. Something Mama herself noticed...

“Bro Jude must like the new girl, she is always on the screen like she is the Mummy G.O”

Wahala!

Wahala be like wetin?

Wahala be like camera man wey dey do soft love with church camera.

(Trouble is when a media guy is using church camera to run his love agenda.)

Let's continue with what happened with the Choir Ministration... When T.J steps on the altar.. Grace is Spelt in Capital letters.

Grace be like what?

Grace be like say you dey sing normal worship, but person dey screenshot you for Instagram crusade.

(Grace is when what you meant to be simple turns into viral drama without your consent.)

And from the choir room to the pulpit stairs, one thing was clear:

T.J. didn't come to chase spotlight.

But the spotlight?

It was chasing her.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 9
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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Mama's Raised Brow

This is still Mabel...Let's step into the woman wing now...where side-eyes come with coded concern. This report is from the room where whispers become orders.

If Daddy G.O. is the lion of Holy & Fire Altar Assembly, then Mummy G.O. is the velvet glove that carries the paw.

You see her smiling on the women's ministry banner, wearing her peach suit and subtle gold chain, don't get it twisted... nothing moves in that church without her knowing.

So when she calls you by your full name and offers you Malt, just know... your file has entered her spiritual cabinet.

And that Saturday evening, T.J.'s file landed on the table.

We were in her office, sorting out details for the next “Daughters of Glory” breakfast hangout.

We had chosen pink and burgundy as colour code (because white scarf is now common), when Mama dropped her Biro suddenly and looked up.

“Mabel... what do you really think about this new girl... T.J. I am thinking of inviting her for a drink with me?”

I blinked.

I no be mumu, (I am not stupid) but I acted slow. Whenever Mama asked you such questions out of the blues, you must understand that the room has shifted to an interrogative room, where everyone is a suspect.

“She seems calm, respectful, spirit-filled. Doesn’t talk much.”

She nodded.

Then sipped her tea.

“She doesn’t talk too much and yet she’s in everybody’s mouth.. Hmm.”

I smiled.

“Because of that rehearsal clip?” I said trying to help T.J stay out Mama’s radar.

“Not just that. I heard some of the protocol boys have started calling her Holy Slay Queen.”

Ah. First time I was hearing that one. It was on point though. If I were to be honest, she was beautiful and had good dress sense.

“There’s something about her that...” Mama continued and then paused “...pulls attention.”

I wanted to say, “Mama, no be her fault, Na oil” (Mama, it’s not her Fault, It’s the Oil) but I kept quiet. You don’t rush defence when elders are still thinking. Especially this elder ...Mummy G.O, the Chief Operating Officer of the Ministry.

Then she said:

“You know I’m for unity. But when attention shifts too quickly, people get distracted from the main thing, this can cause people to stop praying and start plotting.”

Boom.

Right there.

I knew Mama’s heart had started leaning away from T.J.

Not hatred.

But that quiet distance leaders create when they're trying to keep things “in order.”

Yes! ***In Order.***

You know, church order is very important to church owners. I use “owners” intentionally, because my Daddy G.O and Mummy G.O ran the church like their personal company...and Order was one of their most cherished values. No surprises there! Just like the Pharisees loved order and hated Jesus for disrupting it, that’s exactly how Mama would react to T.J. if she sensed even the slightest threat to her sacred structure.

Honestly, I could write an entire chapter on this “Order” matter. Did you know the choir had to submit a list of the praise and worship songs every Saturday night for Mama or Papa’s approval? There was nothing like, “The Holy Spirit took over the praise leader.” No room for divine spontaneity.

So, if Mama was beginning to feel threatened by T.J...or better still, if she believed T.J. was here to disrupt the Church Order...then T.J. had better slow down. Someone needed to warn her.

And I wasn’t sure that person could be me.

I couldn’t afford to jeopardize my position as Mama’s P.A.

On Sunday morning, it became clearer.

During altar service coordination, Mama told the ushers:

“Move new choir members to the far right corner this week. Let’s observe the flow from a distance.”

Flow ?

Me I didn’t argue. I passed the message to Edna and Pastor Dan. I saw the expression on Edna’s face when she heard it...pure delight masked as deep concern.

Then came the moment that sealed it.

After service, Mama and I were walking back to her car. T.J. walked past.

Mama slowed.

Watched her from behind.

Then turned to me and said,

“I don’t doubt she loves God... but is it really God who sent her here, or did she send herself?”

My chest tightened. What kind of question was that?

I didn’t answer.

Because in church, that kind of question isn't just a question.

It's the beginning of suspicion.

The beginning of red tape.

The beginning of "God is watching you, and so are we."

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like new anointing enter church, and old anointing dey hold meeting.

(Trouble starts when fresh grace enters a space that has gotten used to only recognizing old power.)

Later that night, I sat in my room and looked at T.J.'s number on my phone.

She had never called me.

Never asked for help.

Never even asked what time Mama liked visitors.

She just came to church, prayed, and left.

And maybe...that was the real problem.

She didn't come seeking favour.

But favour was locating her anyway.

And people?

They don't always attack what's loud.

Sometimes, they attack what's quiet... but GROWING . They attack it especially if their names are not attached to the story of the Growth.

T.J had not come to bow to Mama...

To be continued...

CHAPTER 10
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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Prayer Mountain Detour

There's something about "let's go to the mountain" that sounds so holy...
Until you realize not every altar is built to honour God.

When Sharon told me Pastor Dan had texted T.J. about a "private prayer retreat for mentorship," something in my stomach turned.

He made it sound like it was a leadership development invitation.

"We're planning a 3-day fasting retreat for promising leaders. Very few will be invited. I sense you should be among."

That was the message.

But guess what?

Only T.J. was invited.

No "we." No "few others."

Just T.J.

Just Dan.

Just them two.

And the location?

One mountain in the outskirts of town.

“Eagle Rock Retreat Centre.”

I’d never heard of it. And I know every Holy & Fire-approved location.

I got the full gist about it from Sister Peace...the soft-spoken girl who helps clean the Choir office. She saw Pastor Dan walk past the admin block holding a brown envelope with T.J.’s name written in big pen.

Curious, she peeked later when she saw the envelope on his table. She saw the printed schedule:

“Personal Encounters

Day 1: Isolation & Voice Training.

Day 2: Prayer Walks & Impartation.

Day 3: Personal Prophetic Sessions.”

Father Abeg!

Me I said nothing.

But when T.J. asked to excuse herself from choir rehearsal for “a 3-day prayer commitment,” I joined dots sharp sharp.

One question though! Didn’t our Spirit filled sister have the gist of Discernment of Spirit..Because Pastor Dan’s motives was not looking genuine.

Another striking thing for me was the way Edna was quick to give her permission. The Edna I knew would make a big deal out of it. Preach about commitment and how Choir rehearsal too was a place of retreat, but on the Contrary she applauded her for taking time to feed her Spirit.

“This is commendable!” She had said with so much joy I was almost fooled.

Day 1: silence.

Day 2: silence.

Then on Day 3 at 1:14 a.m., I got a text from an unknown number.

“Hello. My name is Sister Esther. I am at Eagle Rock Centre. Please, I just wanted to confirm something quietly. Is Sister Tijesuni a junior pastor or someone’s fiancée?”

The text came into the Church's phone number where people send in inquiries. The number is mostly picked from our website.

Wait. What?

I called immediately.

She picked.

Voice shaking.

“Aunty, I’m sorry o. I’ve seen this sister praying seriously. Fire. Like... real fire. But I noticed the brother that came with her has been... um... unusually ‘close’ since they got here on Friday. Like... he goes inside her room to ‘check on her’, sits closely beside her during morning meditation. It is obvious she is not comfortable. Then just now...about 15 minutes ago.. I heard shouting from her room... then silence.”

Goosebumps.

“ Silence?” I asked in fear.

“ Yes! Dead silence.. then I heard someone walk out of her room. Unlike her, I have not heard any prayer from her room after that. I find this strange, because Since she came here Friday night, it’s been prayer every time she is not with the brother.”

“Ha!” this was sounding creepy and scary. My Mind had thought of a million possibilities.

“ Can you please help me check on her?” I asked

“I am sorry..I can’t .. What if it is a crime scene?’ She said

“ Crime Scene!!!” I didn’t like the sound of that.

“ Can you please help go to the Security of the camp and inform them?” I pleaded

“ Aunty, I am sorry oo, I can’t ..What if the brother is outside.. I came to this retreat camp to pray and heal, not to die. I just thought to let you know what is happening. It’s because I recognized her from your Church’s trending clip that’s why I got your number from your website. I am just trying to be my Sister’s keeper, let me end this call before they call me the Sister’s killer... Shalom”

She ended the call...

“Hello!... This lady has hung up”

I was literally shaking...

I immediately called Pastor Dan’s line! He ended the call..

God! I hope they have not dimmed this light!

To be continued...

CHAPTER 11
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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“Did you see her leave here this morning?” I asked the receptionist.

“This morning?” I confirmed again.

“Yes! She left around 6:30am... alone. Quiet. Just carried her bag and entered bike,” she replied.

“Did she leave with the brother she came with?” I asked.

“No. He left around 8am. Are they dating, ma?” the receptionist asked quickly.

“Why did you ask?”

“It was obvious. The brother wanted to literally swallow her. Even Dorcas took pictures of them.”

Pictures?

That was not good. That was so not good for the church brand!

“Oh! Can I see the pictures?” I asked.

Dorcas was called, and she excitedly showed me the pictures.

And in the split of a second, I deleted them permanently.

They were shocked.

“I’m sorry I had to do that... They are not dating. The brother wants to date her, and he’s doing everything possible. If this picture gets out, it will break the sister,” I said, hoping they would understand.

They didn’t understand.

They were furious!

But I knew these things.

I had learnt a few tricks from Mama.

I asked for their account details and forwarded some money from Mama’s purse account with me.

That calmed their nerves.

Wahala be like wetin?

Wahala be like camera wey capture innocent moment and nearly cause church earthquake.

(Wahala is like a camera that captures an innocent moment and almost shakes the whole church.)

But Grace be like wetin?

Grace be like person wey God dey protect even when people dey plot scandal with screenshot.

(Grace is when God protects someone ...even when people are plotting scandal with a screenshot.)

If that picture got out, it will bring ridicule to her. They would say she had been pretending all along. They would not analyse the picture well to see that it was Pastor Dan that was making the moves, but as usual Grace found her.

T.J. didn't come to church for the next two days. I was avoiding calling her, because of Mama.

No post.

No text.

No choir check-in.

Then, Sunday morning...

She walked in.

Usual Ankara Themed dress. At this point I was beginning to think She was a Fashion Designer.

Usual sleek back scarf.

But there was a storm in her eyes.

Not the angry type.

The “I am Unshaken. This is my father’s House” look.

I tried to catch her after service.

She dodged me.

Later, I heard from another sister that T.J. had gone to one of the elders ... Elder Akin... and requested to be removed from the choir for now.

No explanation.

Just like that.

Meanwhile, Pastor Dan was glowing more than usual.

“The Lord is doing deep work in this season,” he said after service. “Some pruning comes with silence.”

I wanted to scream,

“Abeg, who ask you?”

But I just nodded.

Because... church.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like private prayer retreat wey turn to unspoken trauma.

(Translation: Trouble is when something meant to be holy becomes a setup in disguise.)

That night, I went into my small prayer corner in the church.

And I wept.

Not for me.

For her....

Sincerely.. I felt like I was to help T.J flourish in that Church. I felt like I should stand up for her. There was a knowing in my spirit that our Church was dying and T.J was sent to revive it.

But the Question is why did He send the innocent looking girl? He could have sent a prophet! A revivalist!

But a simple looking girl.!

To be continued...

CHAPTER 12
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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The first thing I noticed that Friday night?

T.J. came earlier than early.

Not fashionably late like some fire-branded people who believe Holy Ghost starts at 1 a.m.

She came before 8 p.m.

Sat quietly at the back.

Head down.

Small jotter in hand.

The all-night vigil was themed:

“NO MORE DELAY.”

Me I thought, Na marital delay most people are coming to pray about... but in reality , we have delayed our repentance for too long as a church.

By 9:45 p.m., the worship started.

Edna led, of course.

As usual, pitch-perfect.

Vocal acrobatics.

One song modulated 3 times.

But the atmosphere?

Dry.

Not even small goosebumps.

By 10:30, Pastor Dan climbed stage to raise prayer.

He did his usual:

“Turn to three people and shout: No more delay in your life!”

People obeyed.

But even the shouting felt empty.

It was like heaven put the night on airplane mode.

Until 11:13 p.m.

No mic.

No announcement.

No spotlight.

Just one girl at the back...T.J.

It was time for personal supplication, before Daddy G.O would come on the Pulpit.

She Knelt.

Lifted her right hand.

And started singing...

“Spirit of the Living God... come.”

That was it.

Five words in a song.. She wasn't loud.. the teens around her picked it up... it started spreading like wildfire... I looked at T.J, her eyes were tightly shut with her body curled up as she knelt.

This Girl was commanding power and yet she wasn't bothered about it.

Next thing?

Something happened. The Building literally Vibrated.

A baby at the back stopped crying.

One elder dropped to his knees unprovoked.

I can't explain it!

Daddy and Mummy G.O were not in the service, they were in their offices as usual. You know how Daddy and Mummy G.O stay in their offices until it was time to minister. That was the case, but the Shift in the atmosphere brought them out of their offices...

Before you could say "Amen"... people started praying...rolling on the floor...

Real praying.

Tears. Groans. Hands in the air.

The choir stood still.

Even Edna froze.

T.J. walked forward slowly, no rush.

No swagger.

Just like someone who knew where she was going and who was backing her.

She got near the altar. She knelt in front of the altar. No one was watching except a few of us.. The members were enjoying the moment. They were soaked in his presence.

Pastor Dan who was holding the mic tried to take over and claim the presence, like he was the one who called in Abba..

“Yes, Lord... we welcome You afresh!”

But his voice started cracking.

And then?

He dropped the mic.

And He ?

He Fell.

No usher touched him.

Nobody laid hands.

He fell backward.

Like someone pushed by invisible presence.

People gasped.

Some shouted “Power!!!”

Some Shouted “ Fire”

Daddy G.O and Mummy G.O looked at each other... their powerlessness exposed...

And Me?... I was standing by the sound booth, frozen.

Because I knew.

Something had just been exposed.

Not by man.

But by God.

We were a powerless Church...

Next thing?

A sister started manifesting behind me.

Screaming.

Saying things like:

“Leave me alone! Her fire is too much! She’s exposing us! She’s not supposed to survive!”

Us?

Who be us?

I saw the look of surprise in Daddy G.O’s face...

Before I could move, another one slumped near the usher stand.

Three people started coughing violently.

T.J. didn't panic.

She just knelt.

Lifted both hands.

She Said softly, but I could hear...

“Father, take back Your altar.”

She continued her song and Daddy G.O proved that he was really a servant of God.. He Picked the Mic and handed it to T.J. T.J took it and kept singing.. But I saw Mummy G.O's face... Something... At the time I couldn't identify what it was...

But That was it.. the moment she started singing into the Mic...

Deliverance broke out.

Real one.

Not rehearsal.

People were screaming, crying, confessing.

Even one of the choir guys suddenly began to confess:

“I took her picture to a herbalist! I thought she was the reason I lost my solo part!”

My knees buckled.

Grace be like what?

Grace be like Holy Ghost show up in full force and expose every hidden Cain, Korah and Judas.

(Grace is when heaven decides to clear house ... and starts from the pulpit and choir bench.)

That night, T.J. didn't preach.

Didn't lay hands.

She just sang.

And by 3:17 a.m.,

Every demon hiding in church had started packing their load.

After the vigil, church was never the same again.

But the war?

It had only just begun.

Because now...She had moved from “that quiet sister” to “the one God is clearly with.”

And not everybody was smiling about that...Even the one you didn’t expect.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 13
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
©OPEYEMI AKINTUNDE
AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Let's be honest...After glory comes gossip, and some brethren don't rest until peace is peppered and this time, I'm fighting the urge to scream "Leave this girl alone!"

It didn't take long.

By Sunday afternoon, two full days after the vigil, the WhatsApp statuses were heating up:

"Be careful when power comes too quickly. Not all fire is holy."

"Glory without grounding is a fast route to madness."

"Pray for our sister. Something is happening."

I was in my room, still recovering from Friday vigil, rubbing Robb on my legs (because Holy Ghost fire no dey cancel leg cramps), when Sister Peace called me in a shaky voice.

“Aunty Mabel... T.J. fainted.”

I sat up. “Where?!”

“Her room. I heard from the girl she shares the compound with. They said she was praying after service today, then suddenly screamed and dropped. She’s been taken to Elder Akin’s house.”

Ah. One of the elders that attended the Vigil and was also stunned by the Glory that came into the temple.

Elder Akin.

Our deliverance elder.

If you're in his house, it's either the devil is leaving you, or you're leaving earth. He will cast out all the demons in you, although in the past two years he had not been active in his calling. He also had gone a bit cold.

I rushed over.

Elder Akin’s house was quiet.

Too quiet.

I knocked once.

Twice.

Then his wife opened the door and nodded gently.

“She’s inside. She’s sleeping now.”

I removed my shoes and tiptoed in.

There, on the small visitor’s mattress, lay T.J. Face calm. Blanket pulled to her chin.

Breathing softly.

She didn’t look like someone in torment...She looked like someone after battle.

Elder Akin was in the corner, flipping Bible pages slowly. He had a different countenance . A countenance of guilt.

He looked up at me.

“She’s fine. Nothing demonic. Just exhaustion. But something happened in the spirit. Something serious.”

I nodded.

“Should I tell Mama?”

He shook his head.

“Not yet. Let her rest. The girl fought something deep. If God opened your eyes to what she withstood on Friday, you’d weep for her.”

I believed him.

But not everyone else did.

I started seeing a new twist to the rumours:

“I heard she screamed because she saw a demon in her room.”

“Maybe she has opened herself to strange powers.”

“It’s Possible God is punishing her”

“Abi all this her quiet spirit na pretense?”

“Daddy G.O needs to be careful, all this can be spiritual scam oo”

As I sat watching her sleeping, a choir sister named Dami posted on her IG story:

“Be careful who lays hands on you. Some people carry confusion in the name of fire.”

#justsaying

#protectyouraltar

Subtle? Yes.

But in this season, every sub was a dagger...And the person being stabbed?

Still sleeping...Still recovering.

Still unaware that the same church where God moved through her, was now trying to crucify her quietly.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like say you faint after fighting in the spirit, and your reward na rumour and retweet.

(Trouble is when you go to war for people, and they turn around and call you suspect.)

Even Mummy G.O. called me:

“Mabel, what’s happening to that sister? Why do people keep sending me anonymous messages asking about her?”

I replied gently:

“She’s resting. That’s all. She gave too much.”

Mama sighed.

“Hmm. The spirit of this age... Young people love glory and power, but don’t have what it takes to be carriers of it. She didn’t know ministering is not for babies. I hope she doesn’t give too much and disappear” She smirked..

That one pained me.

Because even Mama was sounding like she was no longer sure.

That night, I prayed a different kind of prayer.

Not tongues.

Not warfare.

Just a heart-cry..

“God... defend your daughter..Don’t let them ruin her before her real assignment begins.”

To be continued...

CHAPTER 14
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Old Prophet, New Games

They brought in Prophet Amos Elijah for the midweek “Fire Refresh” service. I overheard Mama calling a fellow Pastor’s wife asking her to give her the contact of a powerful Man of God who could come refresh the fire in our Church.

To me, it was a matter of pride. T.J’s display of power had revealed the need for fresh fire in the church and they didn’t want it to look like God used a young girl to remind them of what was missing in the church. What I expected was for Daddy G.O to go on a retreat and ask the Lord some questions. Also, they could subject T.J to pass through the different spiritual schools in the church, so she could follow structure even while being a blessing to us in church. This should have been received as a reawakening call, but Mama in particular saw it as belittling for a young girl to be used to set their church on fire.

So Prophet Amos was brought in...This man is not small o.

We’re talking grey beard, white Agbada with shiny embroidery, and a voice that sounded like thunder playing bass guitar.

The flyer called him:

"God's Walking Oracle. A Seasoned Prophet of Deep Dimensions."

This was his first time in our Church.

Church was full by 4:30 p.m.

Even Mummy G.O. wore head-to-toe white lace that evening.

You know it's serious when Mama wears her "I respect this man of God"
Head gear..

T.J. came late.

Quiet as usual.

Sat at the far end of the middle row, notebook in hand.

She didn't stand out.

But true prophets?

They pick up frequency.

After praise and a short word, Prophet Amos walked slowly to the centre.

He started moving in the crowd.

Prophesying.

Mentioning names.

Describing people's dreams from the night before.

Every shout of “Jesus!” and “That’s me o!” made the atmosphere heavier.

Then...

He stopped.

Turned slowly.

Pointed.

Straight at T.J.

“Daughter... yes, you. The one who tries to stay hidden.”

Gasps everywhere.

Even I sat straighter.

You know those moments when your skin already knows, this one is not ordinary.

T.J. didn’t move.

She just looked up. Calm.

“I see fire around you. Real fire. But the Lord says... you must be careful.

Because pride is waiting at your door.”

The whole church exhaled. Loud.

Then he added:

“You carry power. But power without submission is dangerous. Why did you leave the Choir? Return”

Ah....At that point?

I felt it.

The shift.

The slight nod from Mummy G.O.

The hidden smirk on Edna’s face.

Even Pastor Dan, sitting at the corner, dropped a slow “Hmnn.”

I looked at T.J...Her face?...Still calm.

She nodded respectfully. Whispered, “Yes, sir.”

Then quietly bowed her head.

But after service...People’s tongues became microphones.

“So even that prophet has seen it!”

“Did you hear what he said? ‘Pride is waiting at her door’ ...meaning she’s already entertaining it.”

“You see why we said they should test her spirit first?”

I didn’t know what pained me more...

The fact that he picked her out...Or the fact that they used his words to fuel what they had already been brewing.

By Friday, a Christian blog posted:

“Viral Worship Sister Gets Called Out by Senior Prophet ...Is Her Fire Fake?”

I nearly threw my phone.

Because when the devil wants to silence a rising voice, he doesn’t always use witches.

He uses credibility.

He uses people with grey hair and church stamps.

Just like the old prophet misled the young prophet in 1 Kings 13...

By sounding wise,

But speaking against God’s original instruction.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like person wey God dey use, but na another man of God go cut the wire in public.

(Translation: Trouble is when someone God raised gets spiritually embarrassed by someone people revere.)

T.J. didn't speak about it.

Didn't post.

Didn't explain.

I needed to study her calmness.

But for the first time since she entered Holy & Fire Altar Assembly...

She stopped attending midweek service.

And me?..I prayed a very simple prayer that night:

“Lord... Silence the discouraging voices of old prophets sent to distract your daughter from her journey.”

To be continued...

CHAPTER 15
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

You see choir?

Choir is like stew.

When the ingredients are right... harmony, humility, Holy Ghost — the aroma sweetens the whole service.

But when pride, envy, and spiritual eye-service enter... pepper go enter eye.

The Sunday after Fire refresh, Instead of Fire for peace in the church, things came to a head.

The choir meeting was called by Edna “for alignment and spiritual check-in.” which we know in real fact, the heading of the meeting should be "Let's address this T.J. matter without saying her name directly."

We gathered inside the music room after second service.

Ceiling fan spinning slowly.

Mic stand leaning like it's tired of hearing the same wahala.

Edna started gentle:

“We thank God for how far He has brought us. But we must not allow distraction to enter our midst.”

Then she smiled.

But it wasn't a smile.

It was that kind of smile someone gives before giving you a slap wrapped in KJV English.

“Some of us have come in with unusual fire. We bless God...But choir is not a place for competition or silent rebellion.”

Some people were nodding.

Others were side-eyeing T.J. without even blinking.

Then, out of nowhere, Sister Irene ,.. one of the altos who never talks raised her hand.

“Sorry o, Sister Edna, with all due respect, this is beginning to look like intimidation.”

The Room became silent.

“Since that vigil where God moved through T.J., some of us have felt like we have to ‘watch ourselves’ anytime she’s around. Is she a threat? Or is it that we’re just not used to fresh grace?”

Edna blinked.

Shifted in her seat.

“Nobody is intimidated. We are simply protecting the altar.”

Then Irene dropped it.

“But who owns the altar? You or God?”

I nearly clapped, but Holy Spirit held my hands.

That room went cold.

A few people gasped.

One brother stood up, paced small, then sat down again.

T.J. just sat still.

Quiet.

Same posture.

Same expression.

But I could feel her heart beating from where I stood.

Then another sister, Angela, added softly:

“This split didn’t start when she came. It started when we stopped focusing on the presence and started policing personalities.”

Whew. God bless these Sisters.

That was when Edna stood.

“Enough. I see what’s going on...If you all feel you’re too spiritual to be led, maybe I should step down.”

Everybody went quiet...Tension was breathing heavily in that room.

But no one begged her.

In fact...

Three people quietly walked out.

Choir rehearsal?

Over.

Later that evening, a new group chat popped up:

“Altar Sounds : Worship Circle.”

Created by Irene.

T.J. was added.

Angela was added.

And within 24 hours?

Twelve choir members had joined, including myself on a coded level.

Unofficially?

The choir had split.

I sat with Mama later that night.

She was quiet.

Reading something.

Then she sighed.

“What did I tell you, Mabel? That girl is stirring spirits. Even ones we didn’t know were sleeping.”

I nodded.

Because now, even I could feel it...

This wasn't just choir politics anymore.

This was war...And there seem to be powers involved. God was exposing things that had been swept under the carpet.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 16
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Sunday of Stares

They moved her.

Quietly.

Tactfully.

No memo. No meeting.

But choir arrangement that morning had changed and T.J. was told to sit among the congregation.

“Just for now,” they said “Let’s allow the atmosphere settle.”

Which atmosphere?

The one we caused or the one God sent?

I was standing by the media desk when I saw it happen.

T.J. had come in early again.

Always early.

Black and white chiffon gown.

Hair wrapped in a soft scarf like a woman going for a retreat, not drama.

She walked in, headed to her usual row.

Then Brother Wale from the admin team intercepted her.

“Ma, sorry... choir sitting pattern has shifted. Please join the last row today.”

She didn’t argue...Didn’t blink twice... Just said, “Okay.”

And sat..Quietly. In the congregation...No mic.No spotlight.

But guess what?...She still glowed.

And the people? They still looked.

Worship started.

Edna led again.

She was on fire ...vocally.

Ran through five songs like a pro.

But I won't lie to you: the room felt... stiff.

Like we were singing around something...Like the Presence was hovering but not landing.

Then suddenly... halfway through the third song...

T.J. stood.

Didn't walk forward.

Didn't wave hands.

She just stood.

Eyes closed.

Mouth moving ...no sound.

But the air around her...

Shifted.

Again.

People started praying under their breath. Some vibrating.

Some cried silently.

One usher behind her started speaking in tongues without knowing why.

And Edna?

She saw it.

Mid-song, her voice shook.

She looked sideways like she heard something.

Tried to push through with “Holy! You are Holy!”

But the congregation?

Their focus had drifted.

To the back.

To a girl with no mic...yet commanding heaven like her name was etched on the scroll of intercession.

After Service, Edna gave a short “charge” on spiritual authority and order at the Choir office. Funny enough, T.J attended the meeting, sitting humbling in the meeting. I wondered how she was coping. I wondered how she kept coming back to church after every blow.

Subtle...But we got the message:

“You don’t have to fight for spotlight when God is truly with you...

And if God is truly with you, you’ll obey structure.” Edna had said emphatically

Amen o.

Structure.

Even if the structure is making the church a dry land and built to suppress what God is doing?

I just kept quiet.

After service, three sisters and one brother went to meet T.J. at the car park.

They said they just wanted to “pray with her.”

But the moment they circled her and held hands?

They all fell.

Right there on bare concrete.

Slain.

No drama.

No camera.

No choir robe.

Just glory.

Raw. Unedited. Uninvited.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like back-row worshipper wey dey make heaven kiss earth while front-row people dey argue microphone order.

(Trouble is when the person you push to the background still becomes the real altar in the room.)

That night, Edna sent a memo to the music WhatsApp group:

“All unscheduled groupings and worship circles outside approved programs must stop. Let’s maintain spiritual decorum and proper flow.”

Two people left the group that same night.

Me?

I didn't say anything.

But I knew...

They can take her mic.

They can change her row.

But they can't stop the fire that's not theirs to control.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 17
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Family Meeting

Once leadership calls a “family meeting,” just know the matter don pass choir group chat... I was in that room, o. Front seat. No popcorn, just palpitations.

When they said,

“Leadership meeting ... immediately after first service. Boardroom.”

no one needed to ask why.

We all knew.

T.J..

Or let’s just say...The Fire...The Shift...The Unspoken Battle.

Call it anything.

The church had become a pressure cooker, and Daddy G.O. finally wanted to lift the lid.

The boardroom was tense.

The AC was on, but sweat dey people forehead.

Mummy G.O. sat beside Daddy G.O., face unreadable.

Pastor Dan came in last ... clutching his iPad like a shield.

Edna walked in with a file. That one always likes props. I was surprised to see Bro Solomon walk in.. He wasn't the head usher..but then it hit me, the head Usher had put to bed.

I, Mabel, your on-the-ground spiritual CIA, was by Mama's side as usual, notebook in hand ...even though I already knew this gist would live in my head rent-free.

Daddy G.O. started.

"I called this meeting not because I like drama. I called it because God is not an author of confusion...And lately, there's been too much noise in this house."

Everyone nodded.

The kind of nod people do when they don't want to be accused of being the "noise."

He continued:

“A young sister joined us. She carries grace, yes. But grace that causes division must be examined.”

That line.

That was when I knew ...someone had whispered well into his ear. Who else if not Mama...

Then he said:

“Edna... what’s happening in choir?”

Sis Edna cleared her throat like a lawyer in court.

“Sir, the issue is not that we don’t welcome new gifts. The issue is unchecked elevation. People bypassing process...Creating followership without submission.And there’s emotional bias involved...”

She glanced...quickly...at Pastor Dan.

I caught it.

Daddy G.O. folded his hands.

“Is this about spiritual growth...Or spiritual territory?”

Boom.

No one answered.

Then Mummy G.O. dropped her own.

“Sir, the women have started talking...They’re saying we’re favouring one person too much, especially someone who just joined us. That we’re letting her run without shoes while others are still crawling in socks.”

I almost coughed.

What does that even mean?

“Run without shoes”?

Wahala and metaphor dey hold hands in this church.

Then Pastor Dan spoke.

“Sir... I believe she needs spiritual supervision. She’s powerful, no doubt. But power needs shaping.”

Daddy G.O. raised a brow.

“And who will shape her? You?”

Silence.

Pastor Dan shifted.

I wrote “sir is not smiling today” in my notebook.

Then Daddy G.O. did something unexpected.

He turned to me.

“Mabel, you’re close to my wife. You hear what people don’t say in meetings.

What’s your honest take?”

Ah.

Pressure.

I took a breath, just about to speak, when Bro Solomon came to my rescue.

“Sir, can I speak?” he asked, his tone calm but firm.

“Of course... G.O will let you speak,” I muttered under my breath. “Have you forgotten how much your tithe is in this church every month?”

“Please, go ahead,” G.O said.

Bro Solomon cleared his throat and spoke with the weight of someone who had carried this for a while.

“I believe the real issue here is not her presence... but her light. The light she carries is exposing our shadows. It’s not her fault that the people we’ve failed to feed spiritually are now finding food in her presence.”

He paused and let the words sink in.

“Our choir sings lifeless songs ...no weight, no presence, just voices. Some of our pastors preach dry sermons. As an usher, I move around. I see our members ...they’re not writing anything in their notes. Some of them are even sleeping during service.”

You could feel the discomfort growing in the room, but he didn’t stop.

“To be honest, I had been praying for revival. I gave God a deadline ...six months. If nothing changed, I was going to find another church. But now... something is shifting. The plastic experiences are fading. The teens are on fire. People are waking up. Instead of fighting this light, maybe we should pause and ask: ‘Lord, is this You?’”

He said it with wisdom ... truly living up to his Biblical namesake.

Room: Dead silent.

Even the AC paused, like it didn’t want to interrupt.

Then, softly, Mummy G.O spoke.

“You think we’re starving the flock?”

Bro Solomon looked her straight in the eye.

“I think... some are full of routine. Not revelation. And when revelation shows up in a new wrapper, they call it rebellion.”

The silence that followed was heavier than words.

And truth hung in the air like incense.

Now! Truly these are the kind of men that you want to usher you to the altar.

Let me branch small like Holy Spirit sidebar...(Let me digress a little...)

You know say I never mention Bro Solomon for some pages now. It’s not that he backslid o ,,no be that kind story. (I am sure you noticed I have not brought Bro Solomon up for a while...He didn’t backslide)

It’s just that when he noticed Pastor Dan had started “mentoring” T.J with full chest and extra boldness, Bro Solomon just pressed brakes and entered neutral. (That’s because when he noticed pastor Dan was closing in.. He took a step back)

Baba said: “Make dem no drag me enter love triangle wey Holy Spirit no authorize.” (He didn’t want to be involved in gossips)

But now, see as he just opened mouth and dropped wisdom like spiritual elder wey attend angel conference.

My people, is it me or does this brother still carry small candle for T.J?

Abi na revival dey make his voice tremble like that?

(But from the way he just spoke, it seems this brother still has his eyes and heart on our Sister T.J or what do you think?)

Daddy G.O. leaned back.

Closed his eyes.

Then after a long pause, he said:

“We will not quench what God has lit....But we will test every spirit. We will wait... and watch.”

Meeting ended.

No claps.

No benediction.

Just tension and chair noise.

But that day?

Lines were drawn.

Some people left the room with eyes full of holy suspicion. You could see that Bro Solomon had entered some people's Black books.

Others left with quiet guilt.

But me?

I left with one prayer:

“God... if this is war, fight for her before they finish her emotionally.”

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like spiritual family meeting wey look like peace talk, but na hidden war strategy dem dey arrange.

(Trouble is when a meeting called for unity becomes a quiet declaration of sides.)

To be continued...

CHAPTER 18
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Cain's Echo

You see when jealousy takes the mic from the spirit, even dreams start turning into warnings and this one gave me goosebumps I haven't even finished shaking off.

The thing with envy is ... it doesn't just whisper. Once it enters the heart and finds space, it begins to preach.

And Edna?

She had started preaching to herself.

After that family meeting, instead of calming down, she doubled her fasting.

But not the "Lord, cleanse me" kind of fast.

It was more like,

“Lord, expose her.”

“Lord, silence every voice trying to replace mine.”

“Lord, show the church who is truly carrying Your spirit.”

To be honest?

She thought she was praying against rebellion. But what she was really doing?...Was praying against light.

By Thursday, it escalated.

She called a “private midnight prayer” with two other choir leaders ... Sister Dami (yes, Dami) and Brother Gideon.

The title?

“Exposing Hidden Altars.”

She didn’t mention T.J.'s name o.

But all her prayer points were wearing wig and scarf like her.

“Every strange woman lifting hands on holy ground...”

“Every gift that is not grounded in order...”

“Any new spirit confusing old roots...”

They prayed.

They anointed.

They ended with Holy Communion (on top biscuit and Ribena, but God dey.)

Then...

That night.

She dreamt.

I didn't hear it from a third party.

She told me herself.

Friday morning.

She barged into Mama's office while I was helping Mama prep her outfit for a widow's fellowship event.

Face pale.

Eyes red.

Hands shaking.

“I saw blood.”

Mama sat up immediately.

“What kind of blood?”

“It was... everywhere. On my robe. On the choir stand.

Then I saw this old man writing on a wall.

And a voice shouted, ‘You have offered strange fire. Your jealousy has risen as incense before Me!’

Then I fell inside darkness...And a hand pulled me by the neck. Then I woke up.”

The room went quiet.

Mama swallowed hard.

“Are you sure this dream wasn’t from your subconscious?”

Edna blinked. Even me ..I blinked twice.

Then Edna whispered:

“I think I’ve become Cain.”

My chest tightened.

Mama dismissed me with her eyes.

I left.

Quietly.

But my heart was racing.

Because even though she hadn't said it directly, I knew what she was battling.

That line from Scripture had echoed.

Loud.

Ancient.

"Why has your countenance fallen? If you do well, will you not be accepted?"

God had said to Cain.

Cain.

The first brother to turn altar into battleground.

The first man to feel replaced by grace.

The first to let insecurity drive him to violence.

God had warned Him Just like he had sent a warning message to Edna in her dream..

I quickly checked my phone for that Scripture... Gen 4:6-7. It was right there, but the second part of verse 7 was the warning...

“But if you refuse to do what is right, then watch out! Sin is crouching at the door, eager to control you. But you must subdue it and be its master.”

Ha! That was the warning.. That was the blood she saw on her robe. Sin was at her doorstep. May she not Kill T.J out of envy.

I forwarded the scripture to her, hoping the Lord will interpret it further.

Later that evening, Edna posted this on her WhatsApp status:

“Sometimes, in trying to protect the altar, we end up becoming the very thing God is trying to remove.”

Omo. (Oh Boy!)

Everybody knew something had shifted.

She didn't come for choir rehearsal that Saturday.

Didn't text anyone.

Didn't argue about song list.

Just silence.

But in the spirit?

There was a shaking.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like dream wey finally reveal say you dey fight who God sent to help you.

(Trouble is when the Holy Spirit decides to show you that you're actually the villain in a revival story.)

And me?

I prayed again.

Softly.

“Lord, if Edna still has a chance...Save her.Let this repentance be genuine
Before she puts her hand on something too holy to survive.”

To be continued...

CHAPTER 19
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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By the end of this one, my hand was shaking as I wrote in my journal.

The quarterly Leaders' Retreat was supposed to be quiet.

Closed-door.

Invitation-only.

Held in the side hall behind the main auditorium ...small, cozy, no livestream.

Just the core leaders, Daddy and Mummy G.O., and three ushers on rotation. Yes! Bro Solomon was present.

And yes... T.J. was invited.

I wasn't surprised.

After everything, Daddy G.O. still insisted.

“Let the young woman sit and learn. No more hiding. If there’s error in her spirit, this is where it will show. And if there’s truth? Let it strengthen us.”

Some people rolled eyes when her name was announced.

Others whispered.

Me?

I marked my chair behind Mama, notebook ready, ears sharper than eagle’s wing.

Tea break came around 12:30 p.m.

Biscuits, puff-puff, hot Lipton with milk and honey.

I was watching the flow when T.J. reached for her water bottle.

It was a small transparent bottle. Sealed. Label-less.

Just like the ones we normally serve during meetings.

She opened it.

Took two sips.

Paused.

Held her throat.

Coughed.

Eyes widened.

Then she grabbed her stomach and bent forward.

At first, we thought maybe she swallowed air.

Until she began shaking.

Then dropped.

Hard.

Panic...Screaming....Chairs flew.

Daddy G.O. stood.

Mama froze.

People rushed forward...especially Bro Solomon..

I was already dialing 911 ...sorry, I mean Brother Seyi the church nurse.

Then...

T.J. began to speak.

But not like usual.

Low voice.

Gravelly.

Like something else was using her mouth.

“ They Poisoned me...The poison was not from the water...It came from the words...From the bitterness...From the altar that was meant to protect me from those I am fighting. ”

Silence.

Everyone froze.

She clutched her chest.

Eyes shut tight.

Then whispered:

“I forgive them. I release them. But... I am tired.”

Tears rolled down her face.

Then she passed out.

I didn't cry in that moment. But I wanted to.

Because something in my spirit screamed:

“This is more than physical.”

Daddy G.O. stood over her...Raised his hands.

Spoke in tongues I'd never heard him use before... deep, sharp, ancient-sounding.

“Every arrow fired at this vessel backfire!

Every evil hand lifted against her calling ...wither!

Let the altar of this house speak mercy!”

We carried her to the back room.

Church nurse said her vitals were low but steady.

Nothing toxic in the bottle.

No allergic reaction.

Just sudden system crash.

Me?

I knew.

Spiritual arrow.

And that meant someone had tried to shut her down ...permanently.

After the meeting, Daddy G.O. did something he had NEVER done.

He came on stage for the second service and said publicly:

“This house is under testing...Someone tried to destroy what God is doing.

I will not speak names yet. But I will say this...Every hand that fights grace will soon know what it means for grace to fight back.”

The room?

Cold.

Some people wept.

Some looked away.

But up in the second row?

Edna didn't move.

Eyes fixed.

Arms folded.

Face hard.

I thought she had repented! Her countenance was saying other wise.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like say person drink ordinary water, but jealousy turn am to poison.

(Trouble is when spiritual envy becomes so toxic, even harmless things become deadly.)

Later that night, Mama sat with me in her room.

She was quiet.

Then she said:

“This Girl ...I can't explain her”

I didn't respond.

Because in my spirit, I knew...

This battle?

It was no longer flesh and blood.

This was altar vs altar.

Spirit vs spirit.

Cain vs grace.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 20
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Dreams in Technicolor

She was unconscious for three days.

Not coma.

Not sleep.

Just... still...She was breathing.

Like someone who left the room but forgot to take their body along.

The nurse said, “Her vitals are fine, she’s just not responding.”

I said, “Check her spirit. It’s doing conference call with heaven.”

We left her at Elder Akin’s house. That’s where we always take people who need serious intercession. That man’s guest room has seen deliverance, visions, angelic encounters, and one near-Rapture rehearsal.

But T.J’s own?

Was different.

Day 2, around 4 a.m., she stirred. I was there.

Eyes still shut.

But she started talking.

Low, clear voice.

No stammer.

“I see a courtroom...The church is on trial...Angels on the left. Demons on the right...A scroll is unrolling...And a voice is reading out... ‘Accusations against My Bride.’”

We all froze.

Even Elder Akin paused mid-prayer.

“There are names...I see robes. Titles...But the accusation is not sin... it’s envy...Envy that grew until it became witchcraft in white garments.”

Her hands began to shake.

She continued:

“One name is underlined...Someone who began with light,but traded it for platform.”

Then she gasped.

And whispered one name.

“Mama.”

Chills.

I opened my eyes and looked at Elder Akin.He looked at me.

“Mama G.O.?” he mouthed.

I couldn’t even answer.

Because I knew something we had all suspected silently...had just been confirmed spiritually.

T.J. didn’t wake up till the next evening.

When she did?

She sat up.

Didn't ask for water.

Didn't cry.

She just whispered:

"It's not the people...It's the spirit behind them. It entered through unhealed wounds...It's feeding off insecurity... and fear of replacement."

Elder Akin asked gently:

"Do you want us to inform the G.O.?"

She shook her head.

"No. God will tell him Himself...This battle... is between altars...Not personalities."

Then she asked for her Bible.

That night, I went home and cried.

Because I love Mama.

But I also saw how she slowly started tightening her control the moment T.J.'s presence began to draw eyes, testimonies, and quiet loyalty.

It wasn't rebellion.

It was recognition.

And some altars...don't like to share the light.

Unfortunately, evil spirits have hijacked it.

It was Obvious that there were strange spirits in the church who do not want T.J there, and Mama's insecurity, Edna's jealousy and other hidden evils are riding on the wings of these.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like courtroom for heaven where accusation no be fornication or stealing... but envy.

(Trouble is when God checks hearts, and instead of finding Fornication or other kinds of evil, it finds jealousy where praise was supposed to be.)

To be continued...

CHAPTER 21
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Boardroom Fire

Exactly one week after she came out of that spiritual shutdown,
T.J. walked back into the church.

No announcement.

No fanfare.

She just slipped into the back pew like someone checking if the storm had passed.

People stared.

Some greeted.

Some pretended not to see her.

But me?

I was just watching. Because when God restores a wounded soldier,
the battlefield starts looking for new targets.

The next day, an internal memo was sent:

“Special strategy meeting for Revival Week 2025.

All key heads, new prophetic voices, and assigned altar coordinators are to attend.”

Guess whose name was on it?

Tijesuni Adeyemi.

Clear. Bold. Unmistakable.

Someone in admin definitely had boldness.

Or maybe... Daddy G.O. himself added her name. Daddy G.O seem to have checked her out by her himself Spiritually.

Either way, I knew something was about to burst.

Friday. 2 p.m.

Executive boardroom.

Same place we held the “Family Meeting.”

Same air. Same tension.

Present:

Daddy G.O.

Mummy G.O.

Pastor Dan

Edna

Two elders

Four altar team leaders

Bro Solomon!(Daddy G.O seem to have brought him into his corner, since his truthful appraisal)

Me (note-taker and unofficial discernment antenna)

And... T.J.

She sat near the end of the table.

Notebook in hand.

No make-up. No lipstick. Just calm.

Meeting began.

Discussions flowed.

Strategy. Banners. Prayer rota.

Nothing heavy.

Until... Mummy G.O. turned slightly. Looked at T.J.

“Sister Tijesuni... we’ve heard a lot. You’ve seen visions. You’ve had visitations. And recently, we heard you spoke certain names during your ‘recovery.’”

The room tightened.

T.J. looked up. Calm.

“I don’t recall naming anyone directly, ma.”

Mama nodded slowly. But her eyes?

“Still, if God is showing you this much, one would expect loyalty to leadership to be stronger. Why is it that your revelations never come in the presence of order? If God wants to speak to the Church, don’t you think He should speak to the G.O., myself, or some of the elders?”

Boom.

Accusation, delicately wrapped in protocol.

Pastor Dan folded his arms.

Edna gave a small “hmmn.”

Bro Solomon blinked rapidly.

Me?

I stopped writing.

Then...

T.J. said gently:

“Mama...God respects order... but sometimes, He breaks it. If His voice is no longer heard from the highest mountain, He can descend to the valley and speak from there...because He is the God of the mountains and the God of the valley. Sometimes, He may choose to speak through a donkey when the rider refuses to listen.

Order that resists obedience to God is not spiritual... it's political.

God can break order and speak to a Samuel, even when there's still an Eli in the building. A candle cannot see its own base. Sometimes, those at the top

may not see what's beneath their feet. But someone below can... and might be the one to call attention to what urgently needs to be seen.

What's worse is that when God tries to help by disrupting the order, the same leaders who once prayed for His move begin to block the flow."

T.J. had just preached an entire sermon that froze the room. In the almost four months she had been in our church, this was the longest I'd ever heard her speak.

Silence followed.

Then Mama snapped:

"Are you implying I'm blocking God?!"

T.J. didn't flinch.

"I'm saying... when Eli refused to confront what God exposed...judgment came upon the whole house."

Omo. This girl is deep. She Knows her Scripture. I saw the look of admiration on Daddy G.O's face, Bro Solomon's face and a few others.

Room. Dead. Silent.

Then, Elder Joshua ...one of the oldest in the church ...cleared his throat and gave a dry laughter.

“With all due respect...this girl sounds exactly like you did 22 years ago, Mama. When you were the fiery one calling out tradition. Don’t you remember?”

Chairs shifted.

He continued.

“There was a time they tried to silence you too...They Said you were too bold. They Said your visions were ‘unsettling’...But Daddy stood by you...Now another one has come... and we are the ones resisting?”

Mama froze.

I could see the tears starting in her eyes.

She blinked. Hard.

Then whispered:

“But I suffered to build this...I fought Jezebels, manipulators, fake revivals. How do I know she’s not another one?”

Elder Joshua said softly:

“You don’t...But if you keep fighting what you’re afraid of, you might end up silencing what you prayed for. ”

Elder Akin sat there without saying a word! I thought he would add to the conversation and validate T.J after-all He knew who she was..

Then...

Daddy G.O. stood.

Didn’t say a word.

Just walked out of the room.

Meeting: over.

Mummy G.O followed not wanting to break down in front of everyone.

I quickly followed her, or why am I being paid?

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like when the same woman who was once rejected by tradition... now becomes the GATE blocking revival.

(Trouble is when deliverers forget how it felt to be the one misunderstood.)

To be continued...

CHAPTER 22
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

I overheard Daddy G.O. speaking with Mummy G.O. Their voices were low but loaded. The kind of conversation that made you pause outside the door and lean your ear without meaning to. The door was slightly opened. I could see Mummy G.O

It was intense.

“I don’t know why you’re letting the devil use you,” Daddy G.O. said quietly, but there was fire in his tone.

Mummy G.O. flared up. “How dare you say that to me? I’m only being careful. Should I open the altar to just anyone?”

There was a pause. Then his voice returned, calmer but heavier.

“We’re getting tired, my love. You know it. Ministry is weighing on us. Our kids are still young, and the assignment is not slowing down. If the Lord sends us help...help that looks like a younger version of you...you should be humble enough to pull her close, not push her away.”

He sighed deeply.

“I’ve been praying for revival, you know that. But sometimes, the answers we pray for don’t come wrapped in the robes we expect. They don’t come like the tall sons of Jesse. They come like David..small, unassuming, but carrying oil. They come like vessels that have prepared themselves in the wilderness. Instead of pushing her away or fighting her, why don’t you draw her close and hear her story. She may be a General in the body of a young lady.”

She didn’t respond immediately. Her silence said more than words.

“I just don’t want strange fire burning our altar,” she said finally, arms folded across her chest.

Daddy G.O. looked at her. “Strange fire,” he repeated, then shook his head. “Strange fire is when we try to fight the flame God lit Himself. When God raises a light and we try to cover it, that’s when we become the strange ones. T.J. may be unusual, yes. But you were once unusual too.”

She turned her face away.

“You think I’m jealous,” she muttered.

He didn’t rush to deny it. Instead, he spoke with a kind of painful honesty.

“No. I think you’re afraid. And fear often wears the mask of caution.”

A stretch of silence passed between them. Even the ticking clock seemed to slow down.

“You were once her,” he continued. “The fiery young woman no one could understand. You prayed until chains broke, even when people questioned why a woman was leading deliverance sessions. You were T.J., My dear. Thirty years ago. I stood by you”

A single tear traced its way down her cheek, but she didn't wipe it away.

“I've fought to keep this altar pure,” she whispered.

“And now you must fight to keep it pliable,” he answered softly. “The same God who used you might be trying to use her. If we resist, the revival we've prayed for all these decades could pass us by.

“My love, He is the God of yesterday, today, and forever. The God who used you for our generation yesterday is the same God who wants to use another vessel..one much like you...for this generation today. We should be grateful He still wants to move on our altar; it means He intends to sustain what we've built.”

He took her hands, his voice breaking with earnestness.

“Sweetheart, it wouldn't cost God anything to raise her up to start a church right beside ours and draw away our members overnight. You heard Bro

Solomon...he gave us six months before he considered leaving. Do we really want to lose everything God has used us to build simply because we refuse to embrace younger help?"

I felt the ache in his words. He had spent more than thirty years pouring his life into this ministry, and his strength was no longer what it used to be. This...right here...was the church's Achilles' heel: leaders holding on to power even when their hands can't grip the reins like before. In the corporate world, CEOs who want their companies to outlive them hire younger managing directors or step back into oversight roles. But in church circles, we call it "Order" and dig our heels in.

A sigh slipped from her lips. Her posture softened..Just a little

"What if I don't know how to share the spotlight?" she asked, barely above a whisper.

Daddy G.O. stepped closer.

"Then ask the Holy Spirit to teach you. Grace doesn't dim your light. It multiplies it."

She didn't answer, but he saw her grip ease. Her face still held tension, but something had shifted. Surrender? Maybe. Maybe just enough to give room for something new to grow.

"Let's not let the enemy twist what God is doing," he said. "Let's bring her close. Mentor her before rejection mentors her instead. There are a lot of

churches that shouldn't exist out there, that are borne out of rejection from older prophets.”

After a long pause, she finally nodded.

Later that evening, I found Mama sitting alone in her office.

No makeup.

Just her Bible... and tears.

She whispered:

“Mabel...Am I becoming what I once hated?”

And I couldn't lie.

I just knelt beside her, hugged her and wiping her tears.

I silently prayed as I held her..

“Lord... let this house not become the graveyard of the move You sent.”

To be continued...

CHAPTER 23
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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Sunday came.

Big service.

Revival banners already hung outside.

“A NEW SOUND IS RISING.”

How ironic.

By 6:30 a.m., we were already running around ... camera guys plugging wires, choir members in soft makeup, ushers wearing smiles like uniforms.

But me?

I was looking for T.J.

Usually, she arrives before everyone.

Sometimes helps sweep.

Sometimes prays quietly in a corner.

But this time?

Nowhere.

7:15 a.m. — nothing.

8:02 — service starts.

9:30 — still no show.

I texted.No reply.Called.Switched off.

Okay. Now my heart was not just worried ... it was alert.

Because when fire disappears without notice,it usually means something is about to burst.

During worship, Edna took the mic.

She was glowing.

Sharp dress.

Clear voice.

And her confidence? Too loud.

“Today, we raise a new sound of deliverance.Let every spirit bow to Jesus!”

People clapped...She launched into the set list.

First two songs? Power.

Then...third song.

The moment she said,

“Let’s lift our hands and say ‘Lord, fill this house again’...”

The power cut.Lights gone.Sound gone.Mic dead.

Backup generator? Didn’t kick in.

Silence.

People began murmuring.

Some clapped nervously.

Others sat down.

Then a girl at the back shouted:

“Jesus! There’s fire behind the altar!”

Everyone turned.

The back curtain which had never moved in 12 years... was flicking like breeze was blowing from inside.

But there was no breeze.No vent.No AC.

Just a slow... steady movement.

And the scent of burning oil.

I kid you not.

Oil.

Burning.

Not fire.

Scent.

A few people began crying.

A woman fell flat.

Another one started screaming:

“I repent! I lied about her! I lied!”

Wait. Who? Who is 'her'?

That was when I knew...

She was not there.

But her presence was.

It became an exposition...

“ We should have killed Mama, but her prayers have been shielding her. We came in to initiate all the children and teenagers in the church, but she didn't let us. Her prayers are too Hot... We were glad when Edna was fighting her and the authority were against her... We just wanted her out of the church, so we can finish our assignment, but even now, she is praying for the church..” Two ladies from the choir were manifesting big time...

After service, chaos.

Some were asking:

“Where is she?”

“Did she travel?”

“Was she suspended?”

“Did God take her like Elijah?”

Me? I went to her compound.

Gate locked.

Neighbours said they hadn't seen her since Friday night.

No note.

No voice note.

No goodbye.

Just... absence.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 24
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Voice Note

I assure you, I didn't sleep well after this one...

Monday morning, 8:06 a.m.

I was sipping ginger tea and trying to recover from Sunday's "invisible glory but physical blackout" service when my phone buzzed.

Group Chat: HolyFire Choir

A voice note dropped.

No caption.

No explanation.

No name.

Just... 1 min, 56 sec

I almost ignored it.

But something in my spirit said:

“Play it.”

I did.

And from the first two seconds?

My chest locked.

It was Pastor Dan’s voice.

Unmistakable.

Low. Calculated.

But this time... it wasn’t sermon voice.

It was venting voice.

Voice of a man talking privately...that somehow got sent publicly.

Here’s what he said ... word for word:

“See, the truth is... I didn’t plan to destroy her. I just couldn’t stand how fast people were drawn to her. One girl came, and all of a sudden, even Daddy G.O started watching her like she was carrying Elijah’s mantle.”

It continued...

“That’s when I told Edna: let’s humble her. Give her time to cool down.

Let her know this is not Ibadan or wherever she’s coming from.

Here, we have structure. Protocol. Rank.”

“As for that so-called blackout? Tell me how a mic cuts, backup fails, and generator freezes ... unless someone who understands tech made it happen?”

“We only meant to pause her. Not poison her,” he said “That water incident? Me, I wasn’t even part of that mess.”

There was silence. Then he sighed and confessed what he thought he’d never say aloud.

“And about the retreat... I was this close to sleeping with her. The plan with Edna was to get something we could use to blackmail her. We agreed I’d sacrifice my purity for it...twist the story and frame it like she seduced me. Tell me, who would the church believe? The familiar choir Pastor or the mysterious new girl?”

He swallowed hard.

“But... that night... that girl nearly ended me. I don’t even know where the strength came from...one moment I was closing in, the next I was on the ground gasping for air. She pushed me down with force I can’t explain and screamed like thunder. I ran. Oh Boy! I didn’t just run...I fled.”

He paused again. You could hear Guilt sitting heavy on his shoulders now.

“And now... witches in the choir? Real witches! Who knew? But you know what? Thank God. God used her to expose them.”

“Her assignment here should be over. She’s done enough. Honestly, I pray she never returns...not because I hate her, but because her presence was too bright. She made us look like we had no oil... no fire... nothing. Before they now make her Choir Pastor and turn me to her assistant!”

He gave a dry, bitter chuckle. “ She don try.. Make she go another church”

Then silence.

One sigh.

And the note ended.

I froze. I checked the number who sent it. Sister Sharon... She used this her gossip talent well this time...

The chat didn't freeze...

34 new messages... 9 left the group...4 crying emojis... One person wrote:
"God... how did we become like this?"

Within the hour, the voice note had been forwarded.

Pastors group.

Media team group.

Intercessors circle.

Even elder's wives prayer group.

By noon?

Church leadership called for emergency investigation.

That evening?

Pastor Dan deactivated his WhatsApp.

Someone said he Left town.

Turned off phone.

Some said he went to “wait on the Lord.”

Me?

I knew.

He was running from what his mouth had finally exposed.

And Edna?

She came online and dropped this:

“I was manipulated. I thought I was preserving order. I didn’t know I was partnering with fear.”

That post?

Lasted 5 minutes before she deleted it.

But screenshots?

Ah. Those ones have eternal life.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like voice note wey suppose stay inside one phone, but Holy Spirit forward am Himself.

(Trouble is when God decides to let the truth leak, and He uses digital tools to do it.)

That night, church people were quiet.

No prayer chain.

No drama.

No choir rehearsal.

Just reflection.

Because finally?

The enemy had a name.

And it wasn't T.J.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 25
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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Battlefield Altar

I still haven't recovered from what I witnessed that night..Because when the altar becomes a battlefield, no title, no mic, no position can stand...only truth will stand. A lot had happened in just a short period... witches confessing that they wanted to kill our Mummy G.O and initiate the children and teens... What will be left of the church if all of these happened. Also a whole Pastor Dan had said a lot.. Confession without a priest!

The emergency vigil was called "Repentance and Realignment."

No choir ministration.

No guest preacher.

No praise night flyer with someone holding a mic and fire emojis.

Just plain.

A bare altar.

A gathering of tired saints.

And a pulpit waiting for fire or mercy.

Church filled up by 9 p.m.

Faster than usual.

Even people who don't attend vigils showed up.

Nobody wanted to miss what might be the day heaven decided to speak back.

Daddy G.O. didn't wear agbada...Just a simple white shirt and black trousers.He stepped forward slowly.

No protocol.

No intro.

He looked at us and said:

"We have grieved the Spirit.And if we don't repent,our lampstand will be taken."

Silence.

Then he removed his shoes.

"Tonight, the ground we stand on is not carpet... it's judgment ground.

If your heart is not ready to change, please go home."

No one dared move, we all stayed.

And Daddy G.O. knelt and led the first prayer.

“Lord, deliver us from ourselves. Deliver us from flesh..Deliver us from the Cain Spirit, Deliver us from our Altar being Cold, We are neither Cold nor hot... do not spit us out of your mouth.”

That was it.

People fell flat.

Elders. Ushers. Deacons.

Even I...

Mabel, the “hear-and-see-everything” PA...

I dropped on my knees and cried like someone who had just discovered her heart wasn't as clean as her white gown.

Then it happened.

Around 1:14 a.m.

The air changed.

Not like a breeze.

But like a veil tore.

Suddenly, four people started screaming.

Different corners.

Different genders.

Deliverance broke out.

Not the kind where pastors shout “Out!”

No.

This was raw, altar-wide repentance.

By 4 a.m.,

We were not just weeping.

We were washed.

No one remained the same.

And the real revival?

Had finally begun.

Guess what! T.J was actually in church all through, but didn't let anyone see her. It was when church closed, I saw her walk out of the children church. She had participated in the vigil from the children Church...

She wasn't seeking Attention! She wasn't looking for human Worship.. I needed to have a conversation with this lady. It was high time I did. I told myself.

The moment people noticed her, they rushed towards her and asked that she pray for them, she shook her head in the negative...

"Daddy has prayed for you... there is no other Blessing I have to release that he has not released upon you already. He is our father."

I believe there was more she didn't say, but I could read it from her eyes. I believe she wanted them to know she only came to light the church up, and now the Daddy G.O has been lit up, he was the best person to bless them. I was walking towards her to engage her in a conversation, because I was afraid I might never see her again.

It was as if she heard my thoughts.. she walked towards me and we met at the center...

"You are going to write about all of these.. I will see you on Sunday and all your questions will be answered!" She said with a warm smile. She held my hand warmly..I felt a surge of fire...

God! I need this too..

All through out Saturday, I rehearsed different kind of things she was going to tell me and my reactions to them. Eventually Sunday came but it didn't

go as I had rehearsal it, it came with a mighty twist because even after revival breaks out, the accuser of brethren doesn't rest.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 26
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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Back-Door Attack

I didn't see this one coming. At all.

Sunday after the vigil started on a good note..

Different atmosphere.

Service started with silence.

No "Praise the Lord" chant.

No opening joke.

Just people walking in with reverence, like they were entering a courtroom where mercy had just ruled in their favour.

Even Mummy G.O. wore ash grey, not her usual royal colours.

You could feel it ...We'd crossed something.

But when God moves forward, the enemy runs to find old files.

I was in Mama's office after service, folding her scarf when Sister Peace rushed in. Face pale. Voice shaking.

"Aunty Mabel... someone is at the gate asking for T.J."

I blinked. "Visitor?"

"Yes. A man. Says he's an evangelist... and an ex from her past."

Ex?

I dropped the scarf.

We found him waiting at the side entrance.

Clean haircut.

Suit that said "former rebel, now born again." Bible tucked under armpit like a prop.

His name?...Brother Jireh.

Yes. That's what he called himself.

"Evangelist Jireh." He said

“I have been seeing T.J in your services and how people seem to be celebrating her online... it’s not a bad thing, but I came because the Lord told me to bring balance to this revival.”

Which Lord? I wanted to ask Him? Is it the Lord of the Streets, because he looks like a packaged street-boy.

Or is the Lord of his Stomach who is looking for a way to make money from the church?

“Before you build, you must uncover foundation cracks.” he continued..

My eye twitched.

It Turns out...He used to date T.J.

Before salvation.

Before fire.

Back in university.

According to him, they weren’t just in sin, they were “deep in it.”

Then she left him, changed, and vanished.

Now, he said:

“She didn’t confess her past to this church...She’s hiding under anointing. But grace without full exposure is deception I just thought to let you know

the person you are seeing as a saint. She may still have some unresolved issues with the Lord.”

I Slapped him!

In my mind.

Oh Boy!.

Apart from wanting to slap him, I wanted to say:

“So you carried your Bible from wherever you came from to drag her publicly because of one past she has already nailed to the cross?”

But I didn’t.

Because leaders asked him to speak... privately.

Big mistake.

Word leaked.

By evening, whispers started:

“Is she really who she claims to be?”

“Was all that power a cover-up?”

“Is she trying to rewrite her story and lie to the church?”

“ Are you sure, all these power is not from the marine Kingdom?”

“ I had a dream, someone was warning me about her”

Satan dusted his microphone again.

This time, not with envy.

With shame.

I shook my head in pity as to how inconsistent church brethren could be, one minute you fed them, blessed them like the way Jesus fed the Multitude , and the next minute, the Multitude didn't mind that they crucified him.

I found T.J. behind the church later that night,

Alone, sitting on the low wall.

Eyes swollen but dry.

She looked at me and said:

“Is it ever enough?

You surrender. You die to self. Then they come digging up your old grave.”

I said nothing.

Then she whispered:

“They’re right. I was a mess...But the girl they’re talking about? She died.
And they’re angry resurrection didn’t come with an apology letter.”

I choked back tears.

She continued:

“I’m not hiding. I’m just not owned by shame anymore. If only they knew my story ... they would understand that I can’t be easily broken...”

The next day, Brother Jireh posted a video.

5 minutes.

Face serious.

“You all are celebrating her fire, but I saw the ashes. You’re calling her revival, but I knew her when she was rebellion. Be careful who you let lay hands on your soul. There may be unresolved issues in her.”

The video? Went viral.

Wahala be like what?

Wahala be like ex that missed the revival, so he's now doing investigative journalism on your past.

(Trouble is when the devil can't fight your fire, so he tries to stain your identity.)

But the truth?

God already knew her before we ever met her.

And He still said, "I choose her."

To be continued...

CHAPTER 27
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Story from the Heart

The next Sunday?

Church was full before 7:30 a.m.

People that don't come for first service were sitting on windows.

Why?

Because of the "announcement."

Word had gone round:

"T.J. will be addressing the church this morning."

She had gone to speak with Daddy G.O during the week and from the gist I got, she must have spent nothing less than three hours in his office.

So an internal Memo was passed among staff, then on the official church Whatsapp group, it was announced.

Some of the members came for clarity.

Some for scandal.

Some... just to watch.

But heaven?

Heaven was coming for something else.

At 9:02 a.m.,

T.J. stepped onto the altar.

Simple white dress.

No makeup.

Just her Bible.

Choir had finished a short worship. Edna had gone a bit low key after her name entered voice note, but the hate was still evident in her body language.

T.J climbed..

Her tone?

Sweet like honey...with pepper soaked inside.

T.J. took the mic.

Held it gently.

You could feel the weight.

Like it wasn't a mic ...

But instead of defending herself?

She said this:

“A special acknowledgement to Daddy G.O for giving me this platform. Some of you are here expecting details. A story about my Ex...Names. Maybe even tears...But if that's what you came for, I'm sorry. I'm not here to drag my past to this altar. I'm here to exalt the God who buried it....”

Silence.

You could hear someone say “ Hmm”

“Yes. I was in sin....Deep....Yes. I hurt people...Lied....Fell....Repeated the fall. And yes ...the man who posted that video? Was once close to me. But he met me in the tomb....And this version standing here today? Came out on the third day.”

I gasped.

Ayaaaa!

“Jesus didn’t save me halfway....He didn’t edit my story. He rewrote it...Completely....So no... I won’t explain what’s already under the blood...If you want the gossip, you’ll have to dig through Calvary to find it.”

“But I will tell you a little about this girl...Tijesuni. I will tell you about what God did to her and is doing with her”

“I was born by Missionary Parents...” She started..

Oh! No wonder.. I thought to Myself. The passion for the Lord was in her blood even from birth. Her Parents had sacrificed for the Lord.

“My Mother died on the mission field and my father had to bring me to the city so I could stay with family. If only my father knew that staying with him would have saved me from all I had to go through.

I stayed with my mother’s Sister who was born again but married to a man who didn’t fear God. The Man made a mess of my life, from the age of six , I was molested till I was 14. He introduced me into alcoholism, drugs so as to numb the pain of his beating and sexual assault. His wife couldn’t stop him.

I ran from home when I was 14 and started living with one of my male school teacher. He housed me, fed me but I paid with my body. He helped me with my academics , taught me after school. I became his unofficial wife, cooking , meeting his sexual needs in exchange for an education, shelter and food.

By the time I was in SS3, he let me go, because he got married. I had nowhere to go, so I opted for a brothel. I would sleep with an average of 15 men on a daily basis so I could pay my rent , save for my final papers and eat.

I scaled through...

Got into the University.. continued everything illegal or bad in other to survive, the man who made the video was one of my many sexual partners. He meant nothing to me. He was just a means to an end.

But something happened to me that changed everything...

I read a book titled “ Sexmatics”. It was a novel by Opeyemi Akintunde. It exposed my life to the Light of God and I saw how wasted I had become.

The rest they say is history...

I became born again, consecrated myself to the Lord. I had wasted many years on sex, I wanted to get high on Prayers. I wanted to pray till I had no strength. Prayer has become more important to me than food. I replaced my addiction to sex, to addiction to prayer.

It was this consistent life of prayer that opened me up to hearing from the Lord. He showed me this church and told me he wanted me to meet him here. I asked why, but he told me I should obey first...

When I got here.. it started becoming clearer.. I started seeing the plans of the enemy unfold. The kingdom of darkness had marked this church to be closed down before the end of the year.”

Ah! People gasped... but she continued..

“ They had a 3 point agenda..

- 1) Kill the Mummy G.O because they know how she protects the ministry like a Child
- 2) Contaminate and terminate the lives and glories of the next generation
- 3) Ultimately close down the Church.

I told God.. Not under my watch. I told God I would intercede. Before I joined the Church, I had interceded for 35 days before stepping in to the church that day..”

Oh Boy!

No wonder her entry was Grand.. You can't stay in God's presence praying over a matter for 35 days and he won't decorate you with Glory when you appear before men. Esther only prayed and fasted for three days and her face shone before the King. I analyzed.

“However, when I got in.. I was dragged into a battle. The devil came in dressed in Envy but I refused to give up. I came to this church to be an intercessor. I didn't come to this church to compete , I came to compliment, We are members of one body.”

She dropped the mic. I guess she was emotional at that point and didn't want to cry on the altar.

“Lord... this is what You meant when You said..”They overcame him by the blood of the Lamb and the word of their testimony.” I thought

After that?

Nobody spoke.

No closing prayer.

No offering basket.

Just people Praying

Because sometimes, the loudest sermon comes from someone who refuses to perform ...and just lets God stand in her scars.

Grace be like what?

Grace be like when you came to hear juicy gist, but God gave you revival instead.

(Grace is when man tries to make your shame public, but God uses it to announce His mercy and causes a revival.

And from that moment?

Something in our church cracked open.

Permanently.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 28
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
©OPEYEMI AKINTUNDE
AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

Mummy's Moment

When leaders break... revival deepens. This one had every woman in church weeping like children.

It was meant to be a simple women's fellowship meeting.

Theme: "The Weight We Carry."

It was Meant to be light.

Chiffon scarves.

Small chops.

Mama's usual message about "balance between ministry and womanhood."

Instead?

We got a spiritual earthquake.

The meeting started normal.

Worship.

Testimonies.

Announcements.

Then it was time for Mummy G.O. to speak.

She walked in slowly...Not her usual “I own the stage” strut. Just soft steps...Like someone walking with memories.

No excessive makeup. No plenty rings. Just a small Bible and an old photo album.

She climbed the pulpit...Looked around...And said...

“I won’t be teaching today...I’ll be bleeding...If you’re here to judge... leave now.”

Silence.

You could feel the air go still.

Then she opened the photo album.

Held up a picture.

It was her younger version, smiling, eyes full of fire. She had given the media team earlier. It was also projected on the screen

“This was me in 1999...The year I was denied ordination because I was ‘too bold for a woman.’ That year, I went home, cried for three days, and told God...

‘If they won’t give me a microphone, I will become the message.’”

Then she paused.

“I led house fellowships...Prayed till demons screamed...Fasted till my body shook....And when the revival came?...They said I was ‘too powerful to be under a man.’And the same men who once ignored me...started fighting to control me.”

The women stared.

Some mouths were open.

“So I fought...Not just spiritually...I fought for relevance.I fought for a seat.
And along the way...I got scared.”

Then her voice cracked.

“I was afraid...that someone younger, fresher, bolder...would take the light that nearly killed me to earn.”

And then she whispered the name.

“T.J.”

Silence...Gasps.

“I watched her... and at first, I celebrated her...Then I studied her. Then I feared her...And without knowing it...I began to compete.Quietly.Internally. But it was still envy.Dressed in protocol, order and spiritual grammar.”

She wept.

Like deep, shaking sobs.

No one moved.

Some were already crying..

Then she said:

“I almost became Saul...Throwing javelins at David...But God rich in mercy stopped me...before I destroyed the next move. I was the one who invited Prophet Amos so he could search her out for me. Before he came , he told me she was genuine, but I pleaded with him to help me curb her by telling her to watch out for pride...”

And the entire hall?

Cried.

Prayed.

Repented.

Some women stood and confessed:

“I’ve envied my daughter.”

“I’ve competed with a protégé.”

“I’ve hated the one I was meant to raise.”

And Mama?

She left the pulpit, went to the middle aisle...

Knelt.

Lifted both hands.

“Father...Let my generation stop fighting the ones sent to complete what we couldn’t...Let us bless... not block...Empower... not envy...And if we’ve wounded any Davids...please, heal them.”

Grace be like what?

Grace be like spiritual mother open her heart and everybody realise:

We were all hiding jealousy behind protocol.

(Grace is when we finally admit we’ve been hurting others while claiming to protect order.)

That night?

Mama told me a lot of things she couldn't say on the altar. She said the water incident was actually her fault. She said that day as T.J sat in the room, she thought within herself..

“I hope she chokes on that water”

“Mabel, she could have died.. and I would have been responsible. The devil was lurking around looking for whose thought he would use.”

I wanted to tell her T.J had mentioned her name from her vision. T.J had seen clearly..

Mama picked up her phone and opened to 1 Samuel 18:12:

Read it Mabel... this was me..

“And Saul was afraid of David, because the Lord was with him.” I read it...

I knew at that point Mama needed consolation not condemnation . I was not going to add to her self condemnation. Mercy had found her. She had humbled herself..

“Mama.. you have done the right thing.. The Word of God states that ‘ If my People who are called by name shall humble themselves and repent, I will forgive them and heal their land’ ...Mama, Thank you for choosing healing over ego, Mama. I honour you.”

Mama wept like a baby on my laps... To be continued...

CHAPTER 29
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

By Tuesday week service, Mama invited T.J to her office...

T.J walked in like she was walking on egg shells.

But Mama reached for her hand and held it gently.

“Tijesuni... I was wrong.”

T.J. blinked.

“I judged you before I truly discerned you. I let fear of the unknown cloud what God was doing in the now. I mistook your fire for rebellion... when it was actually revival in disguise.”

T.J.'s nodded

Mama smiled, faintly.

“You remind me of who I used to be... before protocol and pressure dimmed my flame. Thank you... for waking us up again.”

She pulled T.J. into a warm embrace.

“Let’s build together... daughter.”

Mama placed her right hand on Tijesuni’s shoulder and the other over her heart. The atmosphere shifted. Her voice came soft, yet strong, soaked with tears and authority.

“Father... thank You for this vessel. Thank You for rescuing her, refining her, and revealing her to us. I bless Tijesuni today not just as a mother in the faith, but as one who recognizes Your hand on her life.

From this day, may your voice never be silenced in Jesus name.

May your feet never slip from the path of purpose in Jesus name

May your oil never run dry in Jesus Name.

May kings listen to your wisdom, and the broken find healing through your words.

You will not fall. You will not faint. You will finish strong.

Heaven will back you.

Grace will crown you.

Glory will follow you.

And even when I am no longer here, may this altar remember your name not for what you endured, but for the fire you carried in Jesus name.”

She took a deep breath and whispered finally,

“Go, my daughter... burn for Him. The world is waiting.”

I felt it.. A release..

Edna stopped coming for rehearsal...After Mama’s message.

No message.

No “I’m unavailable.”

Just... ghosted the choir.

People noticed...Some said she was “processing.”

Others said, “She’s ashamed.”

But me?

I knew.

She was drowning...And the dangerous part? She didn't want to be saved.

I saw her one evening after Wednesday Bible study.

Sitting alone in her car.

Engine off.

Music off.

Just her.

I walked close.Tapped the window.

She looked up ..eyes swollen, face bare, scarf off.

I'd never seen her without a filter.

"Mabel, what if I never come back?"

My chest tightened.

"Then you'd miss what God is trying to do in you."

She scoffed.

"I don't know how to face the altar again.

After everything.

After the lies.

The sabotage.

The bitterness.

What's left of me that God can use?"

I paused.

Then said:

"The part of you that's broken enough to stop pretending."

Tears welled in her eyes. But she said nothing.

That night... she had a dream.

She told me later. And even now, writing this, I feel chills.

She was in a deep pit.

Walls slimy.

No ladder.

At the edge above, she saw T.J. Dressed in white. Holding a thick rope.

"Let me pull you up," T.J. said.

But Edna refused.

“Why should you be the one to help me? You’re the one they all love now.
You’ve taken everything I had.”

Then the ground in the pit began to crack.

Dark smoke began to rise.

Voices whispered:

“Stay with us.It’s safe here. No accountability here. No repentance needed here.”

Suddenly, an old version of Edna appeared beside her.

Eyes red. Wearing her old robe.

“Let me lead you,” the old Edna said.

She followed. But every step forward made the pit deeper...Finally, she screamed:

“God! I don’t want this anymore!”

A hand ... not T.J.’s this time ...reached down.

Scarred. Glorious.Pulled her up.

And she heard a voice:

“The pit was never punishment...It was your classroom. Come out. And rebuild.”

She woke up... screaming and sobbing.

The next day? Thursday Revival hour in the evening...

She came to church.

Early. Sat at the back. Didn't ask for mic.

Didn't wear makeup.

During prayer, she crawled to the altar...Laid flat.

And Kept saying over and over...

“Lord, let my gift be soaked in grace, not ego.”

And honestly?

We all Knew Edna was not the same.

Later that day, she sent this to the choir group:

“Forgive me. I let jealousy become my worship...I poisoned wells. But if you’ll let me, I want to learn how to be a Levite again. Not a celebrity.”

Followed were emojis ...

By Sunday, She told me she wanted to speak with T.J, and she wanted me there.

We saw T.J. after service, and she had such a welcoming expression on her face.

“Sis,” she said, “I’m sorry... I’ve been like Cain...angry with his brother because his offering was more acceptable. Instead of working on himself to measure up or even striving to do better, Cain busied himself with thoughts of how to make his brother disappear. That was me. And I’m deeply sorry.

There’s no doubt...you carry more oil and presence than I do. But instead of drawing closer to learn the secret of that presence, I allowed myself to envy you. For me, it became more about being in the spotlight. I forgot that what happens in our internal organs is what reflects on the outside. Like how someone with a liver issue often shows it through yellow eyes...it’s an internal problem showing up externally. That analogy hits close to home for me, because I’ve seen it personally.

That’s what the presence of God is like too. It’s what we carry internally that manifests externally for the world to see. I should have known better. I’m sorry again.”

T.J smiled, opened her arms, and said:

“Welcome back, my sister. We are not of the Cain generation. We are the generation of brethren who dwell together in unity...complementing one another, not competing against each other.

Let's rebuild together.”

To be continued...

CHAPTER 29
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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When someone truly returns from fire, they don't come back to impress.
They come back to impact.

The Youth Revival Conference was our biggest event of the quarter.

Stage lights.

Banners.

Matching t-shirts.

Prayer chain that started two weeks early. Our church was now a Praying church...

And this year?

Guess who they listed as key speaker for night 2?

T.J.

Yes.

T.J., the girl who was once almost poisoned by her Mummy G.O

T.J., the girl whose past had been paraded online.

T.J., the girl who didn't defend herself, but let fire do the talking.

The flyer carried her name in bold.

T.J. ADEYEMI — “*Prayer..the fuel for fire*” That was the topic she would be speaking on.

Edna had insisted all choristers go on a weekend prayer retreat. She Meant Serious Business...

Mama had started a small Mentorship group called “Sisters on Fire”. Most of us including T.J were there.

The church was ablaze...lit with fresh fire from heaven.

You would think that after T.J.'s open and vulnerable testimony, Bro Solomon would slow down his pursuit. But no...Brother stepped harder on the accelerator. With Pastor Dan now completely out of the picture, he wasn't leaving anything to chance.

It was clear to everyone: Bro Solomon was a *gone* man. He wasn't interested in dating casually...he had marriage in view. And though T.J. tried to hide it, we could tell... she liked him too.

Then came the surprise of the season.

Elder Akin...yes, our Elder Akin, the firebrand deliverance pastor...called me aside one day.

“I would love you to come to my house,” he said. “Bring T.J. with you.”

T.J. and me?

Everyone could see that T.J. trusted me deeply. Why? I couldn't fully explain. But somehow, we had become inseparable...best of friends.

At Elder Akin's house, something unforgettable happened.

He looked at T.J., eyes full of both humility and honor, and said:

“T.J., please forgive me... You did not deserve the silence I gave you. You did not deserve the nods I gave others when they slandered you. I knew you were genuine, but I didn't lend my voice to give you credibility. I was jealous...that through you, people were receiving deliverance effortlessly.

Before you came, I was the reigning deliverance minister. I had to fast for days before the power of God would move.

But you... you would sing, and people would be set free.”

T.J. knelt quietly beside him.

Different ages.

Different backgrounds.

Same grace.

Then, Elder Akin stretched out his arms... and said:

“May the Lord increase the oil upon your life, T.J.

May you go from strength to strength,

From fire to fire,

From glory to greater glory.

I bless the river within you..

It will not dry up.

I bless the flame in your spirit...

It will not burn out.

May you always hear God clearly,

And never be afraid to obey...even when it's costly.

I declare over you:

You will not fall.

You will not fail.

You will not faint.

The battles that made others retire,

Will announce you instead.

May your feet never lack direction.

May your hands never be empty of virtue.

May your name be heard in heaven and feared in hell.

Go, daughter of Zion...

Shake this generation for God in Jesus Mighty Name I pray.”

T.J. wept like a child.

And so did I.

There's something sacred about old mantles being laid on young shoulders...when pride doesn't get in the way.

To be continued...

CHAPTER 30
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

The Banquet of the Broken

Let me just say, if grace had a party, it would look like this.

We called it "The Banquet of the Broken."

A thanksgiving service like no other.

No color code.

No special guest ministers.

Just an open invite to anyone who had ever fallen, healed, or risen again.

You needed no title ... only a testimony.

Flyers were simple:

“Come as you are. Leave as you’re becoming.”

And church? E full.

Even old members that left during the “T.J. scandal season” came back quietly.

Some sat at the back.

Some stood outside.

Everyone... came hungry.

Not for jollof rice.

But for a fresh slice of redemption.

The altar was decorated with torn robes stitched back together. Symbolic.
That even though we broke ...we didn't stay broken.

Edna opened the event with a spoken word:

“I sang my pain into silence.

But Jesus heard the off-key cry beneath my melody.”

Hmm... everywhere.

Then Sister Modupe ... remember the one that once said T.J. was “a silent Jezebel”? ...

Yeah, she came up , hugged T.J. publicly, and said:

“I’m sorry I mistook light for lightning.”

What a line.

But it was during the choir ministration that it happened. T.J was leading.

The room was charged.

Voices raised.

Drums in sync.

Hands lifted.

Then I noticed him...walking in slowly from the main entrance.

Black kaftan.Face humbled.Eyes searching.

Pastor Dan.

Yes, him.

The same Pastor Dan who once called T.J. “a glorified distraction.”

He had gone underground after everything blew up.

Now?

He was back.

Unannounced.

Unarmed.

Unapplauded.

He walked to the front with others who were touched by the ministration.

Kneeling quietly beside the pulpit.

No drama.

Just a soft cry:

“Jesus... I miss you.”

Nobody dragged him up.

Nobody asked him for statements.

We just let the man cry.

Then T.J. did something only kingdom-minded people can do.

She took the mic to him.

And said:

“You once tried to shut my voice.

But today, I lend it to you...to say whatever the Spirit puts in your mouth.”

The crowd gasped.

Dan stood up slowly...Held the mic.

Paused.

Then whispered:

“I was a gatekeeper who locked out revival because it didn’t look like me. I let envy preach louder than the Word. But today, I return... not as a pastor....Just as a prodigal.”

And the hall?

Tongues mixed with Applause...

We were no longer just a church.

We were a family, restored.

Grace be like what?

Grace be like say the same church that once split over scandal, now kneels together at the same altar... holding hands.

(Grace is when the enemy planned division, but God turned it into a reunion service.)

After the service, someone asked me:

“Mabel, what just happened?”

I smiled and said:

“We didn’t just have thanksgiving....We hosted the Holy Ghost.”

To be continued...

EPILOGUE
BATTLE OF THE BRETHREN
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AS INSPIRED BY THE CREATIVE ONE

When Brethren Dwell in Unity

Here we are. This Is me, closing my diary... with a full heart.

The final chapter. Because when grace finishes a story, it leaves no loose ends. Just mercy... and memories.

It was two weeks after the Banquet.

The air in Holy & Fire Altar Assembly had changed.

People greeted deeper. Smiled slower. Prayed louder.

It was as if the whole church had been baptized in humility.

Even Mummy G.O had started teaching from a gentler place. Her last Women's Fellowship session was titled:

“God Still Calls the Ones You Cancelled.”

Let’s just say ... it left us all speechless.

A peace and planning meeting was called.

Old heads.

New voices.

Former rebels.

Former gatekeepers.

I was asked to anchor the moderation.

Me, Mabel.

PA to Mummy G.O.

Friend to everybody.

Witness of the entire shaking... and reformation.

T.J. sat quietly on the third row. She didn’t want a seat at the head table. But when it became the time for restructuring the youth revival department? Everyone turned to her.

She said simply:

“I don’t want to lead it. I just want to guard the flame.”

We understood.

Not everyone who carries fire wants a title. Some just want the freedom to keep burning.

Then Daddy G.O spoke:

“We propose a new framework...where experience partners with energy. Where fathers don’t just correct or criticize sons ... but walk beside them.”

There was a standing ovation.

For the first time, the church wasn't divided by generation. It was united by revelation.

By the end of that meeting,

Pastor Dan asked to step down from Music Pastor. He wanted to rebuild himself.

And me?

I wrote everything down. Because I know how churches forget. But not this time. Not on my watch.

T.J.?

Her best place in church was not to sit with the elders or pastors, but sitting under the tree near the children's department, praying with teenagers. She was their go to person.. In fact, it was T.J that helped Daddy G.O and Mummy G.O's daughter come out of her self harm struggles no one knew about.

No one told her to do it.

It's just who she became.

Not a celebrity.

Not a saviour.

Just a sister who healed... and helped others do the same.

And if you ask me what the biggest miracle of our church was?

It wasn't that T.J. survived the scandal.

Or that Edna came back.

Or that T.J and Bro Solomon got married..

It was that...

Jealousy lost its altar.

Grace be like what?

Grace be like say the church that was once a battlefield is now a home.

(Grace is when church that was once a battlefield is now a home.)

And me?

I'm still here.

Mabel.

Still taking notes.

Still catching whispers.

Still watching stories unfold in pews and pulpits.

Because even after all this...

God is still writing chapters in this church.

THE END.

NOTE FROM THE AUTHOR...

“Battle of the Brethren” is not just a story.. it’s a mirror for the body of Christ.

One that says:

“Let love win. Let envy die. And may we always remember...Grace is not a competition.”

As I bring Battle of the Brethren to a close, my heart returns again and again to the ancient yet living words of Psalm 133:

*“Behold, how good and how pleasant it is for **brethren to dwell together in unity!***

It is like the precious ointment upon the head, that ran down upon the beard, even Aaron’s beard: that went down to the skirts of his garments;

As the dew of Hermon, and as the dew that descended upon the mountains of Zion: for there the Lord commanded the blessing, even life for evermore.” — Psalm 133:1–3

This scripture mirrors the very heartbeat of this story.

Unity among brethren is not a small thing. It's sacred, powerful, and life-giving. Like the anointing oil poured on Aaron's head, unity flows from the top from leadership, from those entrusted with spiritual authority and it trickles down, bringing fragrance, consecration, and healing to the entire body. But what happens when that oil is blocked? When envy, suspicion, or self-interest stops the flow?

In Battle of the Brethren, we saw how dangerous it can be when brethren wound each other ...knowingly or unknowingly. When competition replaces cooperation. When fear of being out-shined overshadows the call to shine together. The altar became a battlefield instead of a birthing ground for revival.

But unity, true unity ... the one birthed in humility and sustained by love .. is like dew upon the mountains. Refreshing. Consistent. Gentle, yet powerful. Dew may seem insignificant, but without it, life withers. It nourishes silently, faithfully. In the same way, when believers live in peace and purpose together, heaven responds. God commands the blessing. Not just a trickle. A commanded blessing ... irreversible, undeniable, overflowing.

So, dear reader, beyond the characters and conflicts, my prayer is simple:

That we will choose unity over ego, reconciliation over revenge, and grace over gossip.

Because God still wants to pour His oil. He still wants to send His dew.

But He is waiting for His brethren to truly dwell together in unity.

Let's not block the blessing. A unified Church is a Blessed church.

With love and prayers,

Opeyemi Akintunde

Author, Battle of the Brethren

Let's Pray this together..

Prophetic Prayers for Unity & Revival

- Lord, heal every wound caused by division in Your house. Let the balm of Gilead flow through every altar where strife once ruled.
- Father, let Your oil of unity flow from the head to the hem. Restore true spiritual leadership that brings peace, not politics.
- Lord, uproot envy, comparison, and hidden competition from among us. Let us see each other through eyes of love and purpose.
- God of the mountains and the valley, speak to every heart resisting divine order. Melt our pride and teach us submission to Your voice.
- Let every spiritual blockage to Your commanded blessing be removed. We receive the blessing of life forevermore over our churches, families, and fellowships.
- Father, raise a generation like T.J ... burning, pure, and bold. May their light never be quenched by fear or tradition.
- Restore trust between leaders and followers, mentors and mentees, elders and youth. Let us truly become one body with one heartbeat.
- Let the dew of Hermon fall afresh upon our dry places. Refresh us, revive us, and renew our zeal for Your presence.

- Lord, when You send help, may we recognize it ... whether it comes in robes or rags, young or old. Teach us to discern Your vessels.
- We declare: in this season, the Church will no longer be a battlefield of brethren, but a birthplace of revival. In Jesus' name, amen.

If this story has blessed and touched your life, remember to say a Word of Prayer for the Author, Mrs Opeyemi Akintunde the writer of this story as INSPIRED by the HOLY SPIRIT... that God never departs from her Life and Home... And for your free gift of Love to her and the ministry in other to publish or produce more of these life changing stories and movies, your gifts are welcomed in cash and Kind...

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